OCBC Bank: End-to-End Research Report

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OCBC Outperforms Peers But Underpublishes AI

As of 7 November 2026, OCBC is Singapore's longest-established bank (formed 1932), the second-largest financial group in Southeast Asia with **S$731.7bn of assets**, and the year's best-performing Straits Times Index stock: nine-month 2026 net profit reached a record **S$6.24bn (+10%)**, banking-operations profit hit a record S$1.90bn in 3Q26, loans grew 14%, the NPL ratio fell to 0.8%, and management raised 2026 guidance on 6 November even as the net interest margin compressed to 1.66% (OCBC 3Q26 press release). Group CEO Tan Teck Long, in post since 1 January 2026 and operating under the eye of the roughly 28%-owning Lee family, has replaced the 2022–2025 "One Group" plan (whose S$3bn incremental-revenue target was beaten in September 2025) with the three-year "Next Frontier" strategy: four shifts (Asia, Tech, Net-Zero, Franchise) with "AI, Digital, Data" (ADD) at the core, a Singapore–Hong Kong twin wealth hub, more than S$1bn a year of technology spend, 600 new relationship managers and only soft financial targets ("stable to improving ROE", cost-to-income in the low-to-mid 40s) (FY25 CEO deck). The structural gaps are equally clear: ROE of 13.5% against DBS's 17.0%, wealth AUM of S$358bn against DBS's S$544bn, a price-to-book above 2x that already discounts the recovery, a 3Q26 group result swung by Great Eastern's bond mark-to-market, and, most relevant to this brief, an AI programme that makes roughly six million decisions a day and runs agentic KYC in production yet publishes no economic-value figure, a research function that issues judgemental house views through a visibly stale web portal, and no quantitative valuation, scenario or forecast-accuracy layer anywhere in the group. That is the opening for an AI-driven forecasting, research-publishing and dashboard platform: pitched as "fit-for-purpose ADD" that industrialises OCBC Group Research's own stated ambition to build "a comprehensive multi-asset research platform", runs on OCBC's on-premise GPU, Cloudera and OpenShift estate, produces the AI inventory, materiality ratings and evaluation evidence that MAS's new Guidelines on AI Risk Management demand by October 2027, and measures its own forecast accuracy and AI value the way DBS already does. The natural sponsors are Kenneth Lai (Global Markets, which since July 2025 owns Group Research, OCBC Securities and A.I. Oscar), Jean Chia and Eli Lee (Bank of Singapore CIO office), Sunny Quek with Chez Anbu (consumer wealth and Wealth Advisory, who distribute through the app and the OCBC WoW avatars), Melvyn Low and Donald MacDonald (Group Strategy and Transformation Office and Group Data Office, the in-house AI builders), Praveen Raina (Group Operations and Technology), with Carina Lee (Group CRO) and Goh Chin Yee (Group CFO) as the risk and value gatekeepers. The user's two papers supply the missing proof points, BharatFinQA's evidence-grounded filing-QA pipeline with pinned-judge evaluation discipline and FinSafeQA-XL's point-in-time, hash-stamped Singapore safe-asset corpus with its grounding-beats-fine-tuning and abstention findings, while the morluto/rea repository turns out to be unrelated to OCBC and contributes only architectural patterns.

A 1932 merger bank worth S$125bn still answers to its founding family

OCBC is "the longest established Singapore bank, formed in 1932 from the merger of three local banks, the oldest of which was founded in 1912", and it has grown mainly by acquisition ever since (AR2025). Its first Hong Kong branch opened in 1923 and its Xiamen branch in 1925, so the Greater China franchise predates

the Singapore merger (OCBC Group Business). The modern group was assembled in five moves: Keppel Capital (2001); Bank NISP in Indonesia, where OCBC became majority owner in 2005 after choosing NISP as its partner in 1997 (OCBC Indonesia history); ING Asia Private Bank in 2010, which became Bank of Singapore and later absorbed Barclays' Singapore and Hong Kong wealth business (2016) and NAB's private-wealth book (2017) (Bank of Singapore); Wing Hang Bank in Hong Kong, wholly owned since October 2014 in what Bloomberg describes as a US$5bn deal approved by the Lee family (Bloomberg via Yahoo, 5 Feb 2026); and PT Bank Commonwealth, merged into OCBC Indonesia on 1 September 2024 (OCBC Indonesia history). A 12.2% stake in Bank of Ningbo bought in 2006 was raised to the 20% regulatory maximum in 2014 and the alliance was extended for another ten years on 17 September 2026 (OCBC release, 17 Sep 2026). In July 2023 the group unified its brand, renaming OCBC Wing Hang as OCBC Bank (Hong Kong) and Banco OCBC Weng Hang as OCBC Bank (Macau), with the China entity renamed OCBC Bank Limited and OCBC NISP adopting the OCBC logo while keeping its legal name (OCBC release, 3 Jul 2023).

GROUP STRUCTURE AND THE GREAT EASTERN STALEMATE

OCBC Ltd owns 100% of its banks in Malaysia (including the Islamic OCBC Al-Amin), Hong Kong, Macau and mainland China, 100% of Bank of Singapore and OCBC Securities, 85% of the IDX-listed PT Bank OCBC NISP, 96% (effective) of Lion Global Investors and a **93.72% economic interest in Great Eastern Holdings (GEH)**, all audited by PwC (AR2025 Note 33.1). Lion Global is held 70% by GEH and 30% directly by OCBC (GEH 2025 Annual Report), and OCBC Bank (Hong Kong) in turn owns OCBC Bank Limited (China), OCBC Bank (Macau) and OCBC Securities Brokerage (Hong Kong) (OCBC Bank (Hong Kong) Annual Report 2025). The group operates close to 400 branches and representative offices in 19 countries and regions with about 33,000 employees (AR2025; OCBC release, 27 Oct 2026).

The Great Eastern privatisation, OCBC's fourth attempt in two decades, failed in 2025 and the group has publicly closed the chapter. After a May 2024 offer at S$25.60 took OCBC to 93.72%, GEH's free float fell below 10% and SGX suspended trading from 15 July 2024; on 6 June 2025 OCBC backed a delisting with a S$0.9bn "final" exit offer at S$30.15 for the 6.28% it did not own (0.8x embedded value, 14.3x earnings, EY opining fair and reasonable) (OCBC release, 6 Jun 2025). At the 8 July 2025 EGM the delisting resolution drew **63.49% of minority votes against the 75% required**, so the offer lapsed; shareholders instead approved a one-for-one bonus issue in which OCBC elected unlisted Class C non-voting shares, cutting its voting stake to 88.2% while preserving the 93.72% economic interest, and GEH resumed trading on 21 August 2025 (OCBC statement, 8 Jul 2025; Dr Wealth). OCBC has said it has "no intention to launch another offer in the foreseeable future" (OCBC clarification, 23 Jun 2025), Tan Teck Long called it "a chapter behind us" at the FY2025 briefing (The Edge via Yahoo, 25 Feb 2026), and the April 2026 AGM confirmed OCBC "is not proactively looking to further increase its shareholding" (AGM 2026 responses). Bloomberg reports the bid fell "at least S$230 million short of minority holders' demands" and that distant Lee relatives who hold GEH shares resisted it (Bloomberg via Yahoo). GEH should therefore be treated as a permanently listed, 93.72%-owned subsidiary whose minority (12% of votes) still matters.

OWNERSHIP: A PUBLIC FLOAT OF 72% BUT A FAMILY THAT MUST STILL APPROVE BIG DECISIONS

OCBC trades on the SGX Main Board as O39 (ISIN SG1S04926220) with 4,501,436,229 issued shares, 131,650 shareholders and about 72.3% public float at 25 February 2026 (AR2025). At the 6 November 2026 close of **S$27.73** the market capitalisation was about **S$124.7bn**, down from S$130.5bn in mid-October after the shares peaked at S$32.57 (Yahoo Finance); the stock was still up 46.8% year-to-date on 23 October and was the top STI performer (OCBC release, 27 Oct 2026). The register is dominated by Lee-family vehicles: Selat (Pte) Limited holds 14.44% including Herald Investment, Lee Foundation 5.13% including Lee Pineapple and Peninsula Plantations, and Singapore Investments, Lee Rubber, Kallang Development and Kew Estate appear on the top-20 list, which together with Citibank Nominees (16.23%) and the other nominee lines accounts for 72.21% of the shares (AR2025 shareholding statistics). Bloomberg puts the family's aggregate at about **28%**, roughly half of its US$38bn fortune, paying more than US$1bn a year in dividends; it notes that "key decisions still need the family's approval", that the family derailed a ~S$2bn headquarters renovation and a sweetened Great Eastern bid, and that Prof Lee Tih Shih, the sole family director since 2015, chairs the board's Executive Committee (a seat held by the chairman at DBS and UOB) and helped recruit Tan Teck Long from DBS (Bloomberg via Yahoo, 5 Feb 2026). The practical implication for any vendor is that capital-intensive proposals meet a conservative shareholder whose influence runs through the Exco, not just the AGM.

BOARD AND COMMITTEES

Andrew Lee Kok Keng (73), independent and a director since February 2022, has chaired the board since 1 February 2023 and chairs both the Remuneration and Risk Management Committees; the Group CEO is not a board member. As of the 2025 annual report the board comprised Andrew Lee, Chong Chuan Neo (ex-Accenture Greater China CEO, chairs Board Sustainability), Chua Kim Chiu (ex-PwC, chairs Audit), Dr Andrew Khoo (22 years at MAS, chairs Nominating, chairs OCBC Hong Kong and, from 14 April 2026, Great Eastern), Prof Lee Tih Shih (non-independent, chairs Executive Committee), Lian Wee Cheow (ex-PwC), Seck Wai Kwong (ex-Eastspring CEO, chairs Ethics and Conduct, chairs Lion Global), Pramukti Surjaudaja (non-independent, President Commissioner of OCBC Indonesia), Tan Ching Yee (retired Permanent Secretary, joined 1 November 2025) and Tan Yen Yen, who retired at the 16 April 2026 AGM; the board and its committees met 30 times in 2025 (AR2025; AGM results, 16 Apr 2026). OCBC's live leadership page on 7 November 2026 lists only eight directors and omits Audit Committee chairman Chua Kim Chiu, which points to a further retirement after April 2026 that could not be confirmed from an SGX announcement and should be verified before use (OCBC Our Leadership). Helen Wong left the board on 31 December 2025 when she retired as CEO but remains chairman of OCBC China and a director of OCBC Hong Kong (OCBC release, 11 Jul 2025).

SENIOR MANAGEMENT: WHO DECIDES WHAT

Tan Teck Long (56) joined OCBC in March 2022 as Head of Global Wholesale Banking after about three decades at DBS, where his last role was Group Chief Risk Officer; he was named Group CEO on 11 July 2025, served as Deputy CEO through December, and took over on 1 January 2026, also chairing the Association of Banks in Singapore and the ASEAN Bankers Association (OCBC release, 11 Jul 2025;

AR2025). The management bench most relevant to an analytics proposal is set out below; OCBC uses neither a “Group CIO” nor a “Chief Data Officer” title, and the Group COO role has been vacant since Lim Khiang Tong retired on 31 October 2024 (Caproasia, 25 Sep 2024).

Executive	Role (date)	Why it matters for an AI forecasting and research platform
Tan Teck Long	Group CEO (1 Jan 2026); chairs the group Wealth Management Committee and the Strategic Resilience Group	Owns “Next Frontier” and ADD; declined to separate AI spend or define AI ROI (Fortune, 1 Jul 2026)
Goh Chin Yee	Group CFO (Nov 2022); also property and corporate services, central procurement	Gatekeeper for budget, guidance assumptions and the 14% CET1 operating range
Carina Lee	Group CRO (1 Jan 2026), ex-Standard Chartered; reports jointly to CEO and Board RMC; chairs Group Credit Risk Management Committee (OCBC release, 24 Sep 2025)	Model risk, AI risk management, third-party risk
Melvyn Low	Group Chief Strategy and Transformation Officer (10 Nov 2025), concurrently Head of Global Transaction Banking (OCBC release, 5 Nov 2025)	His office houses Group Strategy, Transformation, Innovation, Data, Customer Experience and Operational Excellence, i.e. the Group Data Office
Donald MacDonald	Head of Group Data Office (1 Jun 2022); set up the AI Lab in 2018 (OCBC release, 8 Jun 2022)	Builds OCBC GPT, Wingman, Buddy, HOLMES, HELIOS; owns the centralised AI guardrail system
Praveen Raina	Head of Group Operations and Technology (Jun 2021) (OCBC profile)	Infrastructure, architecture, cyber (David Ng’s TISO), quantum readiness
Kenneth Lai	Head of Global Markets (Oct 2020); Chairman of OCBC Securities; sits on GEH ALCO and Investment Committee	Owns OCBC Group Research, OIR, OCBC Securities (since 1 Jul 2025), A.I. Oscar, tokenisation
Sunny Quek	Head of Global Consumer Financial Services (Oct 2022)	Owns Premier/PPC wealth, the OCBC app, OCBC WoW avatars, GenAI advisor training; target to double consumer wealth income by 2029
Jason Moo	CEO, Bank of Singapore (Mar 2023), ex-Julius Baer and Goldman Sachs	Private bank; HOLMES AI, Source of Wealth Assistant, HELIOS
Jean Chia / Eli Lee	Global CIO / Chief Investment Strategist, Bank of Singapore (BoS CIO team)	Authors of the group house view on equities and bonds; Supertrends; CIO Global Advisory Council
Selena Ling	Chief Economist and Head, OCBC Group Research	Macro, FX, rates, credit forecasts; the group’s public forecasting voice
Elaine Lam, Elaine Heng, Gan Kok Kim, Tan Yuen Siang	Heads of Global Corporate, Commercial, Investment Banking and Financial Institutions (OCBC release, 27 May 2025)	Wholesale sponsors for credit and sector analytics; no single GWB head was named after Tan’s elevation

Executive	Role (date)	Why it matters for an AI forecasting and research platform
Loretta Yuen	General Counsel and Head of Group Legal and Compliance (Sep 2010)	Fronted HELIOS; FAA, outsourcing and PDPA sign-off
Wang Ke, Tan Chor Sen, Parwati Surjaudaja, Ang Eng Siong	CEOs of OCBC Hong Kong/Greater China, Malaysia, Indonesia, China	Regional roll-out owners
Greg Hingston; Teo Joo Wah; Wilson He	Group CEO GEH (Nov 2024); CEO Lion Global; MD OCBC Securities	Insurance, asset management and brokerage analytics

Sources for the table beyond those cited inline: the 2025 management biographies (OCBC management biographies), the live management-team page (OCBC) and the Bank of Singapore management committee page (Bank of Singapore). Bank of Singapore added Collins Chin as Global CFO (19 January 2026), Vi Sun Yang from Julius Baer as Head of Private Banking ASEAN (29 June 2026) and Lim Leong Guan as Dubai chief (1 July 2026), and OCBC Hong Kong will install Angus Tsang as Head of Wholesale Banking on 16 November 2026 when Johnny Wei retires (Bank of Singapore release, 10 Jun 2026; OCBC HK leadership).

Wholesale banking earns 39% of profit, but wealth and insurance grow fastest

OCBC reports four operating segments plus “Others”. Global Wholesale Banking is the largest profit engine at **S$3.59bn of FY2025 pre-tax profit (39%)**, followed by Global Consumer/Private Banking (S$2.21bn, 24%), Insurance via Great Eastern (S$1.49bn, 16%) and Global Markets (S$948m, 10%); in 1H26 the fastest growers were Insurance (+43%) and Consumer/Private Banking (+26%) on a wealth-management boom, while Wholesale grew 5% (FY25 condensed financial statements, Note 13; 1H26 media release). Because treasury products sold to consumer and corporate customers are booked in the customer segments, Global Markets’ reported profit understates the markets franchise: customer-flow trading income across the group was a record S$1.35bn in 9M26 (OCBC 3Q26 press release). OCBC publishes segment profit only half-yearly; for quarters it splits “Banking Operations” from GEH, and that split matters because GEH’s contribution collapsed from S$471m in 2Q26 to S$147m in 3Q26 on bond mark-to-market losses while banking profit set a record (OCBC 3Q26 results highlights).

Segment (S$m, PBT)	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	1H2025	1H2026
Global Consumer/Private Banking	1,537	2,215	2,171	2,209	916	1,154
Global Wholesale Banking	3,002	3,845	3,456	3,588	1,733	1,825
Global Markets	649	32	566	948	453	523
Insurance (GEH)	881	891	1,190	1,491	734	1,048
Others (incl. Bank of Ningbo)	870	1,418	1,593	887	762	624
Group	6,939	8,401	8,976	9,123	4,598	5,174

Sources: FY22, FY24, FY25 and 1H26 media releases. Geographically, Singapore produced 59% of FY2025 income and 56% of pre-tax profit (down from 62%/61%), Malaysia 13%/15% (PBT +21% to S$1.38bn), Greater China 14%/18% (PBT +31% to S$1.67bn as allowances fell) and Indonesia 7%/5% (AR25 MD&A).

BANK OF SINGAPORE: PAST ITS US$145BN TARGET, AIMING FOR ASIA'S TOP FIVE

Bank of Singapore, the wholly owned open-architecture private bank, "surpassed our target of US$145 billion in assets under management (AUM) set in 2023, growing our AUM by over 20% in 2025", with revenue also up more than 20%, UHNW AUM up 25% and financial-intermediary AUM up more than 30% (AR2025, Private Banking review). It runs about 500 relationship managers (400 in 2023), hubs in Singapore, Hong Kong and Dubai (where it ranks third behind Julius Baer and UBS and targets 20% of AUM by 2027), plus BOS Wealth Management Europe in Luxembourg and BOS Wealth Management Malaysia (Private Banker International). Its stated ambition is to be "the top Asian private bank, and among the top five private banks in Asia, in the next three to five years", it targets 30% growth in UHNW AUM by 2028, and in June 2026 it reorganised into ASEAN, Greater China and Middle East/Global South Asia market groups while launching a "Family Office Catalyst" vehicle (Bank of Singapore release, 10 Jun 2026). CEO Jason Moo noted that its July 2025 strategic asset allocation framework, "developed by our Chief Investment Office after a year-long study and stress testing of 120,000 portfolios", made it "the first Asian private bank to use the robust optimisation technique" (finews.asia, 15 Oct 2025). Its AI stack is already substantial: HOLMES AI gives RMs tailored investment insights, the agentic Source of Wealth Assistant (June 2025, built with the Group Data Office) cut report preparation "from 10 days to just one hour", HELIOS (July 2026) front-loads due diligence so accounts open in 15 business days against an industry median of about six weeks, and an unnamed external "AI wealth platform" serves financial intermediaries (AR2025; OCBC release, 29 Jul 2026). A vendor lands better by augmenting CIO content distribution and portfolio analytics than by replacing these tools.

GREAT EASTERN: RECORD PROFIT, 16 MILLION POLICYHOLDERS, VOLATILE MARKS

Founded in 1908, Great Eastern has more than S$123bn of assets and more than 16 million policyholders (11.7 million through government schemes), is rated AA by Fitch and AA- by S&P, and sells through a tied agency force of roughly 25,000, bancassurance, digital partners and Great Eastern Financial Advisers in Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia and Brunei (GEH 9M26 release). FY2025 profit attributable rose 21% to a record **S$1,207m** and new business embedded value 19% to S$740m even as total weighted new sales fell

15% to S$1,535m on a deliberate retreat from single-premium products; group embedded value reached S$20.1bn (GEH FY25 summary). Momentum continued in 2026 (1H26 profit +43%, NBEV +28%, interim dividend 35 cents) before 3Q26 profit fell 72% on investment losses and a S$57.1m loss on the regulatory-driven partial divestment of its Indonesian life unit to OCBC Indonesia, completed 1 September 2026 (GEH 1H26 release; GEH 9M26 release). GEH's contribution to OCBC's net profit rose from S$636m (FY2023) to S$882m (FY2024) and S$1,125m (FY2025), about 15% of group profit (AGM 2026 presentation). Its own AI investments are advisory and claims tools (an AI advisory platform that cuts adviser preparation about 75%, AI medical-claims automation), and in March 2026 it launched "Great Eastern Private" for HNW clients with access to Bank of Singapore and Lion Global capabilities (GEH FY25 release; GEH release, 3 Mar 2026). One weak link: Jefferies found Singapore bancassurance new sales fell 6.2% year on year in 2Q26 while agency sales rose 54% (Insurance Business Asia, 1 Aug 2026).

LION GLOBAL INVESTORS, OCBC SECURITIES AND THE RETAIL WEALTH ENGINE

Lion Global Investors (est. 1986, 196 staff, CEO Teo Joo Wah, chaired by Seck Wai Kwong) managed **S$76.7bn** at 30 September 2026, up from S$67.4bn in September 2022, largely as captive manager for Great Eastern's life funds plus a growing co-branded ETF range (Lion-OCBC Securities APAC Financials Dividend Plus, China Leaders, Singapore Low Carbon, Hang Seng Tech) and Singapore's first physical-gold fund, which gathered US$389.9m in under three months (Lion Global, About Us; Lion Global leadership). OCBC Securities (est. 1986, MD Wilson He) was folded into Global Markets as "Global Markets Equities" on 1 July 2025 together with its Hong Kong and Indonesian siblings, giving "centralised oversight of our full suite of financial markets products – equities, FX, rates, and credit" (AR2025, Treasury and Markets review). Its iOCBC platform trades on 15 exchanges with TradingView charting and A.I. Oscar, an in-house deep-learning stock picker trained on more than 4,000 SGX, HKEX, NASDAQ and NYSE stocks that emails each client 15 weekly ideas based on trading behaviour; it lifted under-35 trading activity 50% in its pilot, was extended to Hong Kong bank customers on 24 March 2025, and underpins a target to triple active young investors (OCBC release, 18 Jun 2024; OCBC HK release, 24 Mar 2025). Trades by investors aged 30 and under rose about 60% in the year to September 2026 and OCBC Securities won Euromoney's Best Equities House in Singapore 2026, but it publishes no market share, and its OIR research page was offline ("We are upgrading the iOCBC trading platform") on 7 November 2026 (OCBC release, 1 Oct 2026; iOCBC OIR).

Group wealth-management income, which spans private banking, Premier Private Client, Premier Banking, insurance, asset management and stockbroking, reached a record **S$5.60bn in FY2025 (38% of total income)**, S$3.29bn in 1H26 (41%), with wealth fees up 33% in FY2025 and 25% in 9M26 to a record S$1.33bn, and banking wealth AUM at S$358bn in September 2026 (FY25 media release; 3Q26 press release). Premier Banking now starts at S$350,000 and Premier Private Client at S$1.5m of qualifying AUM for accredited investors (OCBC Premier Banking; OCBC Premier Private Client); both are served by the OCBC Wealth Panel of OCBC, Lion Global and Bank of Singapore experts whose "Wealth Insights" and weekly ideas flow into the app (OCBC wealth advisory). Sunny Quek is targeting a doubling of the consumer wealth business by 2029, and digital wealth revenue grew more than 80% in 2025 (Caproasia, 13 May 2026; AR2025 Consumer Banking review). The OCBC Singapore app, rated 4.7 on 149,000 App Store reviews, integrates ten Asian wallets (Southeast Asia's most connected banking app), Scan and Pay across all major QR networks in China, structured deposits, RoboInvest (WeInvest-powered), fractional gold and silver, and in-app calls; OCBC does not publish user counts (Apple App Store; OCBC release, 20 Nov 2025).

WHOLESALE BANKING AND GLOBAL MARKETS: THE CREDIT BOOK AND THE RESEARCH OWNER

Global Wholesale Banking carried S$220bn of gross loans at end-2025 (corporate 57%, SME 8% of the group book), earned S$5.93bn of income, grew wholesale non-interest income 24% in 9M26 and houses the sustainable-finance franchise (S$86bn committed, S$62bn drawn at September 2026, first in LSEG's 2025 ASEAN ESG-loan table) (FY25 condensed financial statements; 3Q26 press release). It topped Bloomberg's SGD bond bookrunner table for a second year, replaced its global credit-origination platform within 20 months "laying groundwork for future AI integration", runs an AI Copilot for corporate RMs that cuts credit-assessment preparation by up to 30%, onboards more than 90% of SMEs digitally, and was Euromoney's Asia's best bank for SMEs 2025 (AR2025 Wholesale Banking review; Euromoney). OCBC Velocity and the Business app, "Best Business Digital Banking Platform in Asia Pacific" for 2023–2025, already embed cash-flow forecasting tools and AI-generated pre-emptive financing offers (The Asian Banker, May 2025). Global Markets (Kenneth Lai) manages the group's ALM and treasury book, which is why its own PBT jumped 67% in FY2025 on treasury-asset growth; it also runs FX, rates, credit, commodities, the tokenisation platform (bespoke tokenised bonds since November 2024, a US$1bn blockchain US commercial-paper programme, GOLDX tokenised gold fund with Lion Global and DigiFT, live SGD tokenised deposits on Swift's ledger in September 2026) and "OCBC Markets Watch, our first AI-powered WhatsApp chatbot" for corporate clients (AR2025 Treasury and Markets review; OCBC release, 10 Sep 2026). Most important for this brief, the 2025 annual report states that "the establishment of OCBC Group Research under Global Markets marks a significant step forward", with plans to add 30 companies from the SGX "NEXT 50" list, launch USD credit and equity research in the US, Greater China, Indonesia and Singapore, and build "a comprehensive multi-asset research platform" (AR2025, p.45).

OVERSEAS BANKS: HONG KONG PROFIT UP 83%, INDONESIA BUYING HSBC'S RETAIL BOOK

OCBC Bank (Hong Kong), under Wang Ke, earned HK$2,678m in FY2025 (+83%) and HK$1,827m in 1H26 (+45%) on HK$466bn of assets as its ECL charge halved; wealth income rose 40% in the first eight months of 2026, it is hiring 60–70 customer managers and has soft-launched Premier Private Client at HK$8m (OCBC HK Annual Report 2025; OCBC HK Interim Report 2026; The Standard, 29 Sep 2026). OCBC Indonesia (CEO Parwati Surjaudaja since 2008) earned Rp2.73tn in 1H26 on Rp329.5tn of assets with a CASA ratio around 60% and on 4 May 2026 agreed to buy HSBC Indonesia's International Wealth and Premier Banking business (336,000 customers, Rp89.8tn of AUM, 1,300 staff, closing 2Q27) (Kontan, 30 Jul 2026; OCBC Indonesia release). OCBC Malaysia (CEO Tan Chor Sen; 38 branches plus seven OCBC Al-Amin Islamic branches and Pac Lease's 15 equipment-finance branches) is the most profitable overseas market at S$1.38bn of FY2025 PBT and has committed over RM15bn to the Johor–Singapore Special Economic Zone (AR2025). OCBC China (CEO Ang Eng Siong) is a wholesale and markets bank whose economics appear in OCBC Hong Kong's "Mainland China" segment (FY2025 revenue HK$1,980m, PBT HK$623m), and the Bank of Ningbo associate contributed S$968m of share-of-profit in 9M26 (+19%) (OCBC HK Annual Report 2025; 3Q26 press release).

Record S$6.24bn nine-month profit despite a margin that fell 54 basis points

OCBC's net profit climbed from S$5.75bn in FY2022 (S$5.53bn restated under SFRS(I) 17) to records of **S$7.02bn in FY2023 and S$7.59bn in FY2024**, then slipped 2% to S$7.42bn in FY2025 as the net interest margin fell 29bps to 1.91% and the tax charge rose 27% under BEPS Pillar Two; FY2025 nonetheless set records for total income (S$14.6bn), pre-tax profit (S$9.12bn), non-interest income (S$5.46bn) and wealth AUM (S$343bn) (FY25 media release). The FY2025 decline was entirely rate-driven: the S$605m fall in net interest income decomposed into +S$658m of volume, –S$1,236m of rate and –S$27m of day-count, while every non-interest line improved (FY25 media release). Non-interest income's share of total income rose from 28.6% in FY2023 to 37.4% in FY2025 and 42% in 9M26, which is the central fact about OCBC's earnings mix: it is progressively less NIM-sensitive and more fee, wealth and insurance driven.

Metric	FY2022 (restated)	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	9M2026
Net profit (S$m)	5,526	7,021	7,587	7,422	6,237 (+10%)
Total income (S$m)	11,286	13,507	14,473	14,614	11,731 (+7%)
Net interest income (S$m)	7,688	9,645	9,755	9,150	6,798 (–1%)
NIM	1.91%	2.28%	2.20%	1.91%	1.71%
Non-interest income (S$m)	3,598	3,862	4,718	5,464	4,933 (+19%)
Gross wealth-management fees (S$m)	919	896	1,079	1,443	1,549
Cost-to-income	42.9%	38.7%	39.7%	40.2%	39.2%
Credit costs (bps)	16	20	19	17	14
NPL ratio	1.2%	1.0%	0.9%	0.9%	0.8%
ROE	11.1%	13.7%	13.7%	12.6%	13.5%
Customer loans (S$bn)	295	297	319	341	372
Customer deposits (S$bn)	350	364	391	428	461
Banking wealth AUM (S$bn)	258	263	299	343	358
CET1 (transitional / fully phased-in)	15.2%	15.9%	17.1% / 15.3%	16.9% / 15.1%	15.5% / 14.0%
Dividend per share (cents)	68	82	101 (incl. 16 special)	99 (incl. 16 special)	47 interim

Sources: FY22, FY23, FY24, FY25 and 3Q26 releases; the FY2022 column uses the SFRS(I) 17 restatement published in the FY2023 release for like-for-like comparison.

SEVEN QUARTERS: A TROUGH IN 4Q25, A RECORD IN 2Q26, A GEH-DRIVEN DIP IN 3Q26

Quarterly net profit bottomed at S$1.75bn in 4Q25 (impaired allowances of S$236m "largely for two corporate real estate accounts" and a Malaysian medical-insurance adjustment at GEH), set a record S$2.22bn in 2Q26, and came in at **S$2.04bn in 3Q26** (+3% year on year, –8% quarter on quarter), beating the S$2.00–2.01bn consensus (FY25 media release; Beansprout, 6 Nov 2026). NIM compressed every quarter from 2.04% (1Q25) to 1.66% (3Q26) as average 3-month SORA fell from 2.33% to 1.16%, but the 3Q26 bridge shows the inflection: loan yields +3bps, treasury yields +3bps, funding costs –11bps, mix +2bps, and management stated that "higher SORA rates were a net positive to NII as asset yields rose faster than funding costs" while "the benefits from higher US rates would be reflected in the coming quarters as assets reprice" (3Q26 press release). Net interest income of S$2.31bn in 3Q26 was the highest in six quarters, loans grew 14% year on year to S$372bn "led by high-growth sectors including TMT, digital infrastructure, transportation and power & utilities, and real estate in the developed markets", deposits grew 12% to S$461bn, CASA slipped to 48.4%, credit costs were just 6bps and NPA coverage rose to 168% (3Q26 press release). Banking Operations profit has risen for three straight quarters to a record S$1.90bn (+16% year on year), so the 3Q26 group dip is entirely Great Eastern's mark-to-market, which is why management now reports the two separately (3Q26 results highlights).

Guidance was upgraded at every 2026 call. In February Tan guided "stable to growing" total income, a slight-to-moderate NII decline, mid-single-digit loan growth, 20–25bps credit costs and a low-to-mid 40% cost-to-income ratio assuming 3-month SORA of about 1.4% and Fed funds of about 3.5%; by August loan growth was "high-single-digit to low-double-digit" and the ~S$800m balance of the S$2.5bn capital return would, if not bought back, be paid as a special dividend of roughly 18 cents with the FY2026 final; on 6 November loan growth became "low-double-digit", total income "at least mid-single digit", credit costs 15–20bps, and the rate assumption flipped to "one additional Fed Fund Rate hike in 4Q26" with 3-month SORA about 1.2% and HIBOR about 2.9% (FY25 CEO deck; Investing.com 2Q26 call transcript; 3Q26 CEO deck). The 9M26 actuals (loans +14%, income +7%, credit costs 14bps, CIR 39.2%, ROE 13.5%) already sit at or beyond the upgraded ranges; the only original target OCBC missed in the period was Helen Wong's February 2025 call for a 2025 NIM "in the region of 2%" (actual 1.91%) (FY24 CEO deck). Tan cautioned that "customer investment sentiment has been cautious since July" and that 2027's tone "will not change very much … the risk factors are similar" (Reuters via Manila Times, 7 Nov 2026).

CAPITAL RETURNS: 60% PAYOUTS, S$2.5BN PROGRAMME, 14% CET1 FLOOR

OCBC's policy is a 50% ordinary payout of core net profit paid half-yearly with a minimum "A" credit-rating target; on top of that the February 2025 plan returns S$2.5bn over two years via special dividends equal to 10% of FY2024 and FY2025 profit plus buybacks, lifting total payouts to 60% in both years (FY2024 release; AR2025). S$1.7bn had been returned by February 2026 (S$0.7bn specials each year plus cancelled buybacks), the FY2025 dividend of 99 cents cost S$4.45bn, the 1H26 interim rose 15% to 47 cents (S$2.11bn), and Tan said in August that OCBC is "very comfortable operating at CET1 CAR at around 14%" fully phased-in with no equity raise anticipated (Chairman's Reflections; 1H26 media release; Investing.com

transcript). Fully phased-in CET1 has been managed down from 15.3% (December 2024) to exactly 14.0% at June and September 2026 while risk-weighted assets grew from S$249bn to S$270bn, so capital-driven returns beyond the plan are not signalled and the 2027 dividend outlook hinges on earnings (1H26 results presentation). Five-year total shareholder return was 156% through 2025 and the 2025 dividend yielded 5.8% on the average 2025 price (Chairman's Reflections).

VALUATION AGAINST DBS AND UOB: OCBC HAS RE-RATED TO 2X BOOK ON A 13% ROE

At 6 Nov 2026	OCBC	DBS	UOB
Share price (S$)	27.73	69.72	36.88
Market cap (S$bn)	124.5	198.3	60.9
Trailing / forward P/E	15.8x / 14.5x	18.0x / 16.0x	11.1x / 10.6x
P/B (reported NAV basis)	2.05x	2.8–2.9x	1.1–1.35x
Forward dividend yield	3.6–4.0%	4.4–4.6%	4.2–4.8%
9M26 net profit (S$bn)	6.24 (+10%)	8.82 (+2%)	4.17 (+27%)
9M26 ROE	13.5%	17.0%	~9–11.7%
3Q26 NIM	1.66%	1.87%	1.68%
NPL ratio	0.8%	0.9%	1.5% (Greater China 5.0%)
CET1 transitional / fully phased-in	15.5% / 14.0%	15.9% / 14.0%	14.6% / n.a.
Wealth AUM (S$bn)	358	544	204
Loans / deposits (S$bn)	372 / 461	479 / 650	372 / n.a.
1-year share return	+56.0%	+26.8%	+8.9%
Consensus rating, 12-month target	Buy/Outperform, S$31.27 (17 analysts)	Buy, S$79.24	Hold, S$41.82–42.12

Sources: StockAnalysis, Beansprout compare page, DBS 3Q26 release, Beansprout UOB 3Q26, OCBC 3Q26 press release, Investing.com consensus, MarketScreener consensus. DBS's FY2025 profit was S$11.0bn at 16.2% ROE and UOB's fell about 23% to S$4.59bn after S$1.36bn of 3Q25 provisions (DBS 4Q25 CFO presentation; StockAnalysis U11 financials).

Three conclusions follow. First, OCBC was the only one of the three to beat consensus in 3Q26 (DBS missed on a 65% collapse in markets trading income, UOB on a 41% fall in other non-interest income), and its 9M26 profit growth is the strongest from a normal base, which is why its one-year share return (+56%) is double DBS's (Dr Wealth, 6 Nov 2026). Second, the re-rating from a historical average of about 1.18x book

to 2.03x has outrun the ROE improvement, which is the core of the bear case: Citi downgraded to Sell (S$27.50) on 8 October and Macquarie to Hold (S$30.00) on 14 October citing valuation and NIM pressure, JPMorgan holds Sell at S$25.00, while UOB Kay Hian (S$35.70), Maybank (S$37.23) and Jefferies (Hold, S$35.00) sit in a bull cluster; Phillip's Accumulate uses a Gordon-growth 2.31x FY26 book at 14.5% ROE (Investing.com consensus; POEMS Phillip, 11 Aug 2026; Beansprout, 6 Nov 2026). Third, contrary to a common assumption, OCBC's forward yield (about 3.6%) is now the lowest of the three because its price rose fastest; dividend support rests on the FY2026 final plus the residual special (Beansprout compare page). OCBC is the second-largest STI constituent at 18.3% behind DBS at 29.2%, so the three banks are 56.7% of the SPDR STI ETF (SPDR STI ETF holdings, 5 Nov 2026). Year-end closes trace the run: S$12.18 (2022), S$13.00 (2023), S$16.69 (2024), S$19.76 (2025), a monthly peak of S$31.99 at end-September 2026 and S$27.73 on 6 November (Yahoo Finance chart data).

The S$3bn One Group target gave way to a Next Frontier with few hard numbers

Helen Wong's 2022 refresh was an eight-pillar, three-year plan: four "Drive Growth" priorities (capture rising Asian wealth through Singapore–Hong Kong hubs, support ASEAN–Greater China trade and investment flows, unlock value from the New Economy, drive the low-carbon transition) and four "Reinforce Strengths" enablers (a "One Group" integrated customer approach, transformation and digitalisation, people and culture, capital and risk management) (OCBC ASEAN–Greater China Update, 3 Jul 2023). In July 2023 it was sharpened into an ASEAN–Greater China thesis with a headline target of **S$3bn of cumulative incremental revenue over 2023–2025 "on top of current growth trajectory"**, four goals (top-two financial institution in ASEAN by assets, structurally stronger income generation, better cost-income, focused capital deployment) and a set of sub-targets: more than S$50m invested in Greater China transaction banking, 500 regional cash-management mandates, doubled investment-banking revenue, 26,000 new Hong Kong SME customers, a 50% rise in Greater China franchise revenue in ASEAN by 2025, Bank of Singapore at US$145bn AUM and 500 RMs by end-2025, and doubled Greater China premier RMs and AUM (OCBC release, 3 Jul 2023; 2023 deck). Progress was reported as S$500m of incremental revenue in 2023, the Greater China-in-ASEAN revenue goal met "ahead of time for the second consecutive year" in 2024 with a near-30% rise in new-to-bank Chinese companies entering ASEAN, and then: "In September 2025, we surpassed ahead of time our target to deliver $3 billion in incremental revenue above the 2023 growth trajectory" (AR2024; AR2025, The Power of One Group). OCBC never published the annual attribution beyond the 2023 figure, so an outside analyst cannot reconstruct how the S$3bn was counted; the FY2023–2025 scorecard it did publish shows banking pre-tax profit flat (S$7.5bn to S$7.7bn, a 1% CAGR), group wealth income up at a 14% CAGR to S$5.6bn, wealth AUM up 14% a year to S$343bn and GEH's contribution up 33% a year (AR2025, The Power of One Group). The "top two in ASEAN" goal was declared met by the chairman's statement that the S$676bn combined asset base makes OCBC "the second largest financial services group in Southeast Asia" (AR2025).

THE NEXT FRONTIER (25 FEBRUARY 2026): FOUR SHIFTS, ADD AT THE CORE, SOFT TARGETS

Tan Teck Long unveiled "The Next Frontier" with the FY2025 results rather than at an investor day, and restated it at the 16 April 2026 AGM. It names five megatrends (geopolitical tension, demographics, rising Asian wealth, AI and digitalisation, sustainability) and four strategic shifts with "ADD at our core": an **Asia Shift** ("capture ASEAN–Greater China flows", a "One-ASEAN" proposition, "rising Asian wealth flows through our SG-HK twin wealth hubs"); a **Tech Shift** ("Customer Centric ADD Strategy – Right Customer, Right Product, Right Time" and "intensify focus and coverage on technology, including digital infrastructure and tech supply chain"); a **Net-Zero Shift** (green sectors, SME transition); and a **Franchise Shift** (Singapore: "Whole-of-Wealth" across banking, wealth and insurance plus a "Silver proposition for the super-aged society"; Hong Kong: grow the affluent segment and "scale up Global Markets"; Malaysia: affluent growth via the Great Eastern Malaysia ecosystem and JS-SEZ flows; Indonesia: "Grow OCBC Private Bank") (FY25 CEO deck; AGM 2026 presentation). The financial framing is deliberately soft: "Expect stable to improving ROE, driven by a stronger focus on higher-returning businesses" and "Maintain cost discipline with CIR at low to mid 40%"; asked in August for an aspirational ROE, Tan said "I'm not quite ready to share because there are so many factors involved" (Investing.com transcript, 7 Aug 2026). Morgan Stanley's Nick Lord said the strategy "makes sense" but offers no concrete ROE target and no special-dividend guidance beyond 2026 (Bloomberg via Yahoo, Feb 2026). The AGM added texture: the strategy is three years long, "Data is the foundation, Digital enables customer and employee journeys, and AI is added when it becomes fit for purpose and cost-effective", "Indonesia stays", first-order Middle East exposure is about 2–3% of lending, and a S$5bn office redevelopment was deferred (The Fifth Person, 20 Apr 2026). The quantified commitments are inputs rather than outputs: "more than SGD 1 billion annually in technology over the next few years", 600 additional relationship managers over three years, a Wealth Management Committee chaired by Tan with the heads of OCBC, Bank of Singapore and Great Eastern, and "double-digit [AUM] growth over the next few years" (The Asian Banker, 1 Jul 2026; Investing.com transcript). A strategy that specifies inputs but not outputs, and guidance revised three times in a year, leaves room for a proposal framed around measuring and forecasting the outcome of those inputs.

WEALTH, SUSTAINABILITY, M&A AND PEOPLE: THE CONCRETE 2026 COMMITMENTS

Wealth is the engine of both strategies. Sunny Quek "reiterated the goal of doubling consumer banking wealth income by 2029, one year earlier than previously set"; OCBC will add 30–50 relationship managers in Hong Kong in 2026 and aims to be a top-10 lender there by 2030 after 1Q26 Hong Kong net profit rose 88% and wealth income 50%; Bank of Singapore targets 30% UHNW AUM growth by 2028 with Dubai as a third hub and a rebuilt family-office team under Paul Chua (The Asian Banker, 1 Jul 2026; Reuters via Yahoo, 15 May 2026; WealthBriefingAsia, 29 Apr 2026). On sustainability, the S$50bn-by-2025 target was beaten in September 2023 at S$52bn, after which Helen Wong said "whatever target you set becomes just a number to be beaten"; commitments reached S$80bn at end-2025 and the live targets are now sectoral (net-zero financed emissions by 2050 with 2030 targets for power, oil and gas, real estate, steel, aviation and shipping, covering close to 40% of corporate lending), an SME target (12,000 SMEs and S$25bn of SME commitments by 2028) and up to S$17bn of UK financing by 2030; OCBC reports MSCI AA and FTSE4Good membership but no Sustainalytics or CDP score (The Edge via Yahoo, 3 Dec 2023; OCBC release, 16 May 2023; OCBC release, 7 Apr 2026; Sustainability Report 2025 via MarketScreener). On M&A, Tan is explicit:

“We are very disciplined with acquisition … my personal preference is portfolio relating to wealth, like the HSBC wealth acquisition … we are actually quite risk averse”; the pattern is bolt-on retail and wealth books in Indonesia (PT Bank Commonwealth, completed May 2024; HSBC Indonesia, closing 2Q27) and no disposals (Investing.com transcript; OCBC release, May 2024). Headcount was 33,323 at end-2025 (–1%); about three in five employees have taken AI, digital or data training in three years under an “AI for All / AI for Practitioners / AI for Leaders” framework with 17-week analytics and 22-week “Data Science and Agentic AI” tracks, and the annual report’s stance is that “many of today’s roles may evolve or even disappear as automation accelerates … our approach is grounded in redesigning work around people” (AR2025; Mothership citing Business Times, 24 Apr 2026). The vocabulary a pitch should mirror is therefore fixed: “ADD”, “Right Customer, Right Product, Right Time”, “fit-for-purpose”, “human-in-the-loop”, “Whole-of-Wealth”, “twin hubs”, “One Group”, “Asia/Tech/Net-Zero/Franchise Shift”, “silver proposition”, “China plus n”.

OCBC spends over S$1bn a year on technology but cannot say what AI returns

OCBC has been building AI in-house since it launched “AI Lab@TOV” on 14 March 2018 with an initial S$10m, three data scientists and an “AI-first” ambition; that unit became the Group Data Office under Donald MacDonald in June 2022, and by the 2024 annual report “about six million decisions in the Bank are made by AI each day” across “over 300 AI use cases” (OCBC release, 2018; OCBC release, 8 Jun 2022; AR2024, Creating Value Through AI). The generative wave started with **OCBC GPT**, built in OCBC’s private Azure environment on OpenAI models and delivered through Microsoft Teams to about 30,000 staff in November 2023 after a six-month trial in which investment-research, product and marketing staff reported finishing tasks about 50% faster; alongside it sit Wingman (a coding assistant giving developers 20–30% uplift, built in-house in under two weeks), Buddy (a knowledge assistant over 150,000 pages) and Document AI (OCBC release, 24 Oct 2023; Microsoft, 8 Nov 2023). MacDonald’s design choices are the ones a vendor must respect: about 80% of the work is still traditional machine learning, generative AI runs “largely on-premise using open-source tools on its large GPU infrastructure” at “effectively zero” incremental cost, one contact-centre use case would have cost about $3m in public-cloud API calls, roughly 350 systems feed a Cloudera data platform adopted in 2015, “we have 30 plus Gen AI applications running in production”, HOLMES processes 200,000 pages of research a day into RM talking points, scam screening runs in under 15 milliseconds and most use cases are built in under a month when the data is ready (The Asian Banker, Jan 2024; CMOtech Asia, 19 Aug 2025). The 2024 report also set 2027 targets with no stated baseline: 75% of customer-service requests AI-assisted, 100% of roles augmented, 20% higher staff productivity and “2x revenue contributed by AI” (AR2024).

2026: THE NARRATIVE MOVED FROM INTERNAL PRODUCTIVITY TO CUSTOMER-FACING WEALTH AI

The 2025 annual report highlights agentic AI in KYC (tasks that took up to ten days now take about an hour, with a human in the loop), an AI Copilot for corporate RMs that generates ESG, financial and industry analysis and cuts credit-assessment preparation by up to 30%, agentic code assistance worth up to 30% engineer productivity, 20–30% less coding and testing effort, voice AI for reminder calls and “close to S$80 million in cost avoidance from technology modernisation” (AR2025, AI/Digital/Data; AR2025, Operations and Technology). Three 2026 launches define the current posture. On 15 April OCBC rolled out six months of

generative-AI skills training to about 900 Singapore wealth advisers, with LLM-generated client scenarios built on anonymised behavioural data; trained advisers booked double the weekly appointments of untrained peers and revenue rose 50% over three months (OCBC release, 15 Apr 2026). On 1 July it unveiled **OCBC WoW**, billed as "the first AI-native bank mobile app in South-East Asia", with avatars "Wendy" and "Wayne" that deliver "personalised OCBC Group insights and house views" on a four-layer architecture (data ingestion, deterministic guardrails, AI agents, output modules), in an invitation-only beta for staff and Premier Private Client customers with at least S$1.5m, English first and Mandarin, Bahasa Melayu and Bahasa Indonesia to follow; Fortune reported the avatars are "trained on proprietary data from the bank's research team" (OCBC release, 1 Jul 2026; Fortune, 1 Jul 2026). On 29 July Bank of Singapore launched HELIOS, an agentic due-diligence platform that surfaces compliance-qualified leads to RMs and targets 15-business-day account opening, with Loretta Yuen calling it "a paradigm shift for compliance where we are not just enabling business, but originating opportunities" (OCBC release, 29 Jul 2026). The culture is employee-led experimentation: a 22 October 2026 "One-Person Company" hackathon for all 33,000 staff drew thousands of AI-agent submissions, about three-quarters from non-technology functions, with more than 400 prototypes screened by internally built agents and finalists refined at the SIT x NVIDIA AI Technology Centre (OCBC release, 26 Oct 2026). OCBC Malaysia alone spends more than RM10m a year on AI-focused people development across about 480 programmes (The Star, 12 Sep 2025).

What OCBC does not have is a way to say what any of this earns. Tan's position is that "AI is just a tool" to be embedded in process redesign, that OCBC "expects to spend over one billion dollars a year on technology for the next three years" without separating AI from the total, and that "you have to spend a lot of energy to quantify the benefits of AI … the energy we spend trying to do so may be equal to the amount of time we take to roll out new AI initiatives"; in August he added "it's quite difficult to identify exactly how much is due to AI" and "when it comes to AI, actually, we are very cost conscious" (The Asian Banker, 1 Jul 2026; Fortune, 1 Jul 2026; Investing.com transcript, 7 Aug 2026). Critics have noticed: The Asian Banker's October 2026 assessment says OCBC's AI narrative lacks spending data, outcome metrics and peer benchmarking, with benefits "framed as possibilities rather than demonstrated results", Fintech News calls the "300+" use-case count "older data" against DBS's 430+ and S$1bn of economic value, and Bloomberg's coverage of the tech budget warns that rising costs "could squeeze the cost-to-income ratio" under scrutiny from long-term shareholders (The Asian Banker, 27 Oct 2026; Fintech News Singapore, 14 Oct 2026; The Next Web, 1 Jul 2026). If the S$1bn is realised it is roughly 17% of FY2025's S$5.88bn opex; 1H26 opex already grew 10% and 3Q26's cost-to-income was 40.8%, so the cost line is absorbing the spend and the bar for any vendor to show attributable revenue or cost-out is rising (OCBC 1H26 release; 3Q26 release).

INFRASTRUCTURE, LEADERSHIP AND THE SCAM-SHAPED RISK CULTURE

OCBC's stated posture is hybrid cloud "so that we don't have any dependency with any particular provider": phase one moved internet banking, mobile and contact-centre applications, phase two targets payments and loans, and the Enterprise Data Science Platform runs on Red Hat OpenShift over Cloudera and Hadoop; AI Lab job postings prefer an "on-premise distributed framework" with Hadoop, Trino and an Elastic vector database, while a data-platform posting lists AWS S3, Glue, Athena, EMR and SageMaker across a hybrid estate (Frontier Enterprise, Jan 2023; Built In Singapore). No Google Cloud relationship exists beyond 2018 voice banking, Microsoft appears as the Azure OpenAI and Teams host, and partners are large regulated counterparties (J.P. Morgan Kinexys, Citi, Swift, Ant International, Visa, OneConnect) rather than startups; OCBC has no venture arm (Microsoft, Nov 2023). Multi-year commitments include the S$500m OCBC

Punggol hub for up to 4,000 mostly technology staff due in 1Q27 with an SIT lab, HK$1.5bn for Greater China technology by 2026 including a near-HK$1bn modernisation of the Hong Kong platform, engineering hubs in Kuala Lumpur, Shanghai, Shenzhen and Jakarta, a S$240m regional data centre, a quantum roadmap with QKD over Singtel's network and NUS, NTU and SMU research projects, and SOC 2 Type II plus the highest-tier Cyber Trust Mark (OCBC release, 18 Sep 2024; OCBC release, 17 Jul 2025; GovWare). Decision rights are split three ways: Praveen Raina's Group Operations and Technology owns infrastructure, architecture and cyber (David Ng's Technology Information Security Office; Thomas Kok's ISDRM reports into Risk), MacDonald's Group Data Office builds models under Melvyn Low's Strategy and Transformation Office, and business sponsorship comes from Quek, Moo, Lai and Ling; the "Group CISO" title was held concurrently by CRO Noel D'Cruz until his retirement and its current holder is unconfirmed (OCBC 2024 management committee).

The risk culture was shaped by the December 2021 SMS-spoofing scam: 790 customers lost S$13.7m, OCBC reimbursed all of it as a one-off goodwill gesture, and on 26 May 2022 MAS imposed a 1.3x operational-risk RWA multiplier worth about **S$330m of additional capital** for deficient incident response (MAS release, 26 May 2022; OCBC statement). The remedies became products: a kill switch (February 2022), 12-hour cooling-off periods, Android anti-malware blocking that saved over S$2m in its first month, Money Lock (over S$3.3bn locked within two months), in-app calls and AI payment screening (OCBC release, 16 Feb 2022; OCBC release, 25 Jan 2024). Outages recurred without disclosed root causes on 28 August 2023, 18 December 2025 and 23 October 2026 (a Friday-afternoon login and PayNow disruption with 767 Downdetector reports at its peak that OCBC called "intermittent slowness"), and a May 2026 dark-web claim of an OCBC Malaysia breach was found to be fabricated (The Star, 23 Oct 2026; Lowyat.NET, May 2026). Recognition is steady but second-tier: Euromoney's best digital bank in Singapore in 2024, Asian Banker awards for GenAI productivity (2024) and AI personalisation and process automation (2025), and two TAB Global AI Excellence Awards in May 2026 (the RM Credit Copilot and AI infrastructure), against DBS's global sweep (Euromoney, 2024; The Asian Banker, 14 May 2026). Hiring in 2025–2026 targets AI Lab data scientists building "agentic systems", RAG and recommenders, hybrid AWS platform engineers, digital-asset custody analysts and cyber roles; no quantitative-research or forecasting role was found, which is consistent with a bank that builds distribution and operations AI but not a forecasting layer (Built In Singapore).

Nine named analysts publish the house view, but nobody publishes a model

OCBC's sell-side-style research is one team, rebranded in 2025–2026 from "Global Markets Research & Strategy" and "Treasury Research" to **OCBC Group Research**, housed in Kenneth Lai's Global Markets division and led by Chief Economist Selena Ling, with Tommy Xie (Head of Asia Macro Research), Frances Cheung (Head of FX and Rates Strategy), Christopher Wong (FX strategist, also gold), Sim Moh Siong (precious metals), Lavanya Venkateswaran (Senior ASEAN Economist), Cindy Keung (Hong Kong economist), Carmen Lee (Head of Equity Research) and Samuel Wong (Senior Trading Strategist, OCBC Securities) as the traceable 2026 by-lines; credit-research authors are unnamed on 2026 notes (OCBC Singapore 3Q26 GDP note, 14 Oct 2026; OCBC HK 2H26 outlook release, 5 Aug 2026; OCBC Market Insights). The catalogue is a daily Treasury Outlook, a Weekly Macro View, a monthly Research Monitor (the only place the full SGD rates and SGS forecast table appears), semi-annual Global Economic Outlook and FX and Rates Outlook decks (the December 2025 edition runs 69 pages with technical charts on

21/50/100/200-day moving averages, MACD and RSI), a daily Asian credit snapshot, a Credit Week in Brief, a Monthly Credit View, a semi-annual Singapore credit outlook, country notes and a thin stream of Singapore equity notes (OCBC research hub; 1H 2026 FX and Rates Outlook). Distribution is PDF on ocbc.com, email, "OCBC Research Insights" podcasts on Telegram, daily syndication to FXStreet, Bernama and the Malaysian press, and television (FXStreet, 3 Nov 2026). The public infrastructure is visibly dated: the research hub's footer reads "© Copyright 2004 – 2021", its equity filter returned no items on 7 November 2026, the Premier "Money Monday" page still carries 2017 assets and claims "16 highly experienced equity analysts" and coverage of "200 credits globally", the October 2026 Market Insights masthead sits beside a 2022 webinar, and the FX and Commodities link returns a 404 (OCBC research hub; OCBC Money Monday).

THE WEALTH PANEL IS BANK OF SINGAPORE'S CIO VIEW RELABELLED

The OCBC Wealth Panel, launched in July 2011, lists eight members in October 2026: Carmen Lee, Eli Lee (Chief Investment Strategist, Bank of Singapore), Jean Chia (Global CIO, Bank of Singapore), Christopher Wong, Selena Ling, Tommy Xie, Vasu Menon (Managing Director, Investment Strategy) and Lim Yuin (Chief Investment Strategist, Lion Global) (OCBC Market Insights). Its monthly output for Premier and Premier Private Client customers is a Global Outlook written by Ling, Equities and Bonds pieces written by Eli Lee and a Wealth Insights piece by Wong, delivered through ocbc.com, the OCBC app's "Wealth Insights" and "Ideas" tabs, emailed updates, monthly client sessions and, since July 2026, the OCBC WoW avatars; the only process description is a 2017 investor deck citing "over 200 years of collective investment experience, providing unified house views" feeding "model portfolios" (OCBC Global Outlook, Oct 2026; OCBC sell-side analysts' day, 2017). Bank of Singapore's CIO office under Jean Chia (Portfolio Management and Research Office spanning macro, strategy, FX, equity and fixed-income research and DPM), with Eli Lee, Chief Macro Strategist Mansoor Mohi-uddin, Chief Portfolio Strategist Owi Ruivivar, Head of Equity Strategy Low Pei Han and Head of Fixed Income Strategy Boh Hui Ling, is the group's only unit publishing global multi-asset tactical allocation and five-year thematic research: the twice-yearly "Supertrends" (July 2026 edition: Navigating Chokepoints, A Whole Portfolio Approach, China's Renaissance, "AI – Anything, Everywhere, All at Once", The Longevity Economy), backed by a nine-member external CIO Global Advisory Council (PIMCO's John Studzinski, KKR's Lauren Goodwin, PIIE's Adam Posen, Apollo's Torsten Slok and others) and a CIO Summit in Hong Kong with Howard Marks (BoS CIO team; Hubbis, 14 Jul 2026). A separate Wealth Advisory unit under Chez Anbu writes the group's most explicit AI-valuation commentary as op-eds. OCBC Investment Research survives as Carmen Lee's Singapore-centric equity function with a fair-value convention (2026 picks: Hong Leong Asia, Boustead, Keppel, Sembcorp, UOL, City Developments; "overweight" Singapore), but its legal entity disappeared from the August 2026 credit disclaimer, consistent with consolidation into the bank (OCBC Insights, 4 Sep 2026; Credit Week in Brief, 18 Aug 2026). Lion Global publishes a monthly one-page "LionGlobal Says" grid scoring each market Positive/Neutral/Negative with a P/B-based Cheap/Fair/Expensive label; Great Eastern's views appear only inside fund annual reports (LionGlobal Says, Oct 2026; Great Eastern MAX annual report 2025).

The tooling behind all this is conventional. Charts cite Bloomberg, CEIC, MAS, Singstat and Reuters polls; the March 2026 10-year Treasury forecast was built by analogy to 2022 oil-shock breakevens plus end-2022 real yields rather than from a model; the October 2026 gold piece ran a 1990–2026 portfolio backtest; A.I. Oscar is behaviour-based idea generation, not forecasting; the only AI in the research workflow is OCBC GPT for drafting, an internal tool that "summarises thousands of research reports daily" for RMs, and the avatars that personalise house views; a centralised guardrail system monitors "the accuracy and consistency

of all generative and agentic AI models" including hallucination checks (Updated interest rates forecasts, 19 Mar 2026; The Asian Banker award, 2025; The Straits Times via Magzter). OCBC has announced no AI-generated forecasts, valuation models or automated client research publishing, and no Bloomberg, Reuters or Consensus Economics forecast-accuracy ranking naming OCBC could be found; its verifiable research accolades are OIR's 2016 Thomson Reuters "Overall Top Award-Winning Broker" and OCBC Securities' Euromoney Best Securities House in Singapore 2024 (iOCBC OIR; Euromoney, 13 Sep 2024).

CURRENT HOUSE VIEWS: AI BULL MARKET INTACT BUT "PRICED FOR EXTRAORDINARY OUTCOMES"; ONE MORE FED HIKE

On AI valuations, every OCBC unit discusses capex and leverage qualitatively and none publishes a valuation or payback model. Vasu Menon in January 2026: "Markets are very nervous that this is going to be another dotcom bubble, but we don't think so. We think AI is here to stay; it's a multi-year super trend", with a call to raise gold to 10% of portfolios (The Edge Malaysia, Jan 2026). Bank of Singapore's July 2026 AI Supertrend expects "structural double-digit earnings growth", judges hyperscaler capex revisions "justified" and flags "AI-linked issuances … accelerating in the IG space and also increasingly extending in HY and private credit" and "debatable" monetisation, without using the word "bubble"; Eli Lee on 31 August argued yields are "unlikely to rise to levels that would derail the long-term artificial intelligence (AI) driven equity bull market" because hyperscaler net leverage is 0.4x at a median AA- rating (BoS AI Supertrend, 14 Jul 2026; BoS, 31 Aug 2026). The most pointed line comes from Chez Anbu on 7 September 2026: "the AI powered stock boom is entering the proverbial moment of reckoning … the story has become a bit crowded, over-leveraged and priced for extraordinary outcomes", "capital expenditure is not automatically good news; it is, in fact, a claim on future profits", the market "is beginning to demand payback", and investors should size core infrastructure for volatility, favour bottlenecks (power, cooling, grid, packaging, networking) and trim concentrated single-stock positions, all without a single valuation metric (OCBC Insights, 7 Sep 2026). The October 2026 house view keeps **US equities Overweight** ("the AI-driven earnings story remains most compelling", capex momentum through 2027, Quality Growth style), Europe Underweight, Japan and Asia ex-Japan Neutral (favouring China, Hong Kong, Taiwan and Singapore), Singapore Overweight, fixed income a modest Underweight with Neutral duration and a 3–5-year preference, and "higher for longer" rates; Ling notes equities "continued to find support from strong AI-related earnings … despite periodic concerns over stretched valuations"; Lion Global rates the US "Positive/Expensive" and Taiwan "Expensive" and lists "heavy AI investment could strain company cash flows" as a risk (OCBC Equities, Oct 2026; OCBC Bonds, Oct 2026; OCBC Global Outlook, Oct 2026; LionGlobal Says, Oct 2026). The market context is a 5 November 2026 sell-off led by AI data-centre stocks (S&P 500 –4.4%, Kospi –5.3%) and Bloomberg's estimate that about US$32 trillion has been added to the S&P 500 since ChatGPT's release, more than half from ten companies (AP, 5 Nov 2026; Bloomberg).

On rates the 2026 call history shows how far views travelled. The December 2025 outlook's base case was "50bps of Fed funds rate cuts between now and end-2026"; by 19 March 2026 it was one cut pushed to 3Q26 with the 10-year Treasury at 4.10% year-end; by August "US Interest Rates to Remain Unchanged This Year"; after the FOMC's September 25bp hike to 3.75–4.00% the October view is "we now expect the US central bank to deliver an additional 25-basis-point rate hike by year-end", most likely in December, a view shared by Group Research, Bank of Singapore and management's own FY26 assumptions (3-month SORA about 1.2%, HIBOR about 2.9%) (1H 2026 FX and Rates Outlook; 3Q26 CEO deck; OCBC Global Outlook, Oct 2026; OCBC Singapore note, 14 Oct 2026). Singapore 2026 GDP was revised from 2.0%

(December 2025) to 3% (March) to 5.2% and then **5.5%** on 14 October after 3Q26 growth of 5.4% "turbo-charged by AI- and electronics-related activity", with MAS seen on "an extended hold … at least out to the January 2027 policy meetings" and 2026 core inflation at 1.8%; ASEAN-5 growth is forecast at 4.9% for 2026 with Malaysia and Indonesia both at 5.2%; China 2026 GDP is held at 4.6% with an RRR cut more likely than a rate cut; Hong Kong 2026 GDP is 3.8% with 3-month HIBOR at 2.95% by year-end (OCBC Singapore note, 14 Oct 2026; Business Today, 19 Aug 2026; OCBC HK release, 5 Aug 2026). Gold's end-2026 target went from US$4,800 to US$5,600 in January and back to US$4,360 (silver US$67) in June, "lowered, but not the direction", with a "constructive medium-term view" in October; USD/SGD trades a subdued 1.2740–1.2850 range around 1.2790 with a "constructive medium-term SGD outlook" capped by an S$NEER already in the upper half of its band (NST/Bernama, 26 Jan 2026; TMGM, 1 Jul 2026; FXStreet, 3 Nov 2026).

THE GAP AGAINST DBS AND UOB IS VISIBILITY, INFRASTRUCTURE AND QUANTIFICATION

DBS Group Research fields "a team of 15 economists and strategists", "more than 60 analysts covering more than 600 companies" across seven markets, "over 100 publications monthly", a dedicated Insights Direct platform and, in 2026, AI thought leadership such as "The Trusted AI Financial Hub" with its Global AI Financial Hub Index (20 May) and "Intentional AI" (12 October) (DBS Group Research careers; MarketScreener/DBS, 20 May 2026; DBS newsroom, 12 Oct 2026). UOB's Global Economics and Markets Research publishes a full 15-person team page, a Quarterly Global Outlook, a "UOB House View 4Q 2026" PDF, a standing FX, rates and commodities forecast table, Central Bank Watch and even employs a "Business Data Designer" for infographics (UOB research team; UOB research portal). Against that, OCBC has no public team page, forecast tables only inside PDFs, no online forecast page or dashboard, no company-level global valuation models (its 2026 AI pieces name Nvidia, Broadcom, SK Hynix, Micron, TSMC, ASML, Vertiv, Schneider and Eaton descriptively, without targets), narrative rather than simulated scenarios, personalisation limited to A.I. Oscar and a gated avatar beta, and no public forecast-accuracy record, while global houses it competes with for wealth clients publish formal frameworks such as Goldman Sachs's "AI: In a Bubble?" and the ECB's August 2026 CAPE analysis (OCBC Insights, 3 Jul 2026; Goldman Sachs Research; ECB blog, 17 Aug 2026). The 2026 revision amplitude (Fed: two cuts to one cut to none to hikes; Singapore GDP: 2.0% to 5.5%; gold: US$4,800 to US$5,600 to US$4,360) is itself the strongest argument for continuously updated, scenario-based forecasting with tracked accuracy, and it provides the baseline against which any vendor's forecasts can be scored.

Capital is ample; the binding constraints are margin, Greater China property and MAS's rulebook

OCBC is one of seven MAS-designated domestic systemically important banks and must hold CET1, Tier 1 and total capital of at least 6.5%, 8.0% and 10.0% of risk-weighted assets plus a 2.5-point capital conservation buffer, i.e. 9.0%, 10.5% and 12.5% all-in, with a countercyclical buffer currently at zero (AR2025, Capital Management; MAS D-SIB framework, 2015). At 30 September 2026 it reported CET1 of 15.5% on the transitional final-Basel-III basis and **14.0% fully phased-in** (its own operating target), Tier 1 of 16.4%, total capital of 18.3%, a 6.5% leverage ratio, all-currency LCR of 130%, SGD LCR of 211% and NSFR of 111%, with the transitional-to-final gap narrowing as MAS's output floor steps from 60% in 2026 to 72.5% on 1 January 2029 (OCBC 3Q26 press release; Allen & Gledhill on the MAS circular). A new layer is

coming: MAS's May 2026 consultation proposes external TLAC of 14% of RWA for local D-SIBs with a five-year phase-in and no counting of CCB-funded CET1, which arithmetically OCBC already covers but which will require eligible senior non-preferred-style issuance (MAS Consultation Paper P011-2026). MAS's 2025 industry-wide stress test found that under an adverse scenario of a deep Singapore recession, 46–74% equity falls and 25–45% property falls, D-SIB aggregate CET1 would bottom at 9.8% in Year 2, above the 9.0% requirement, with each bank individually compliant (MAS Financial Stability Review 2025). OCBC is rated Aa1 by Moody's and AA- by S&P and Fitch; solvency is not the constraint on a new analytics budget, earnings sensitivity is.

CREDIT: BUILDING AND CONSTRUCTION IS 28% OF LOANS AND 54% OF NPLS

Of S$341bn of loans at end-2025, Singapore carried 44% and Greater China 21% by credit-risk residency; by industry, building and construction was the largest exposure at **S$95.3bn (28%)**, housing loans S$72.6bn (21%), and that property sector held S$1.74bn of the group's S$3.24bn NPAs (AR25 MD&A). Greater China is the weak spot: its NPL ratio rose from 1.4% to 2.0% in 2025 as NPAs climbed 41% to S$1.45bn after "downgrades of two corporate real estate accounts" in 4Q25, a further S$300m of new NPAs from two Greater China CRE accounts arrived in 2Q26, and the exposure comprises Hong Kong S$34bn, "offshore" China-risk S$20bn, onshore mainland S$9bn, Taiwan S$5bn and Macau S$3bn (FY25 results presentation; POEMS Phillip). Management says Greater China CRE exposure was cut by more than 10% over two years, and the 2026 data (NPAs down 3% quarter on quarter to S$3.04bn, 3Q26 credit cost 6bps, 9M26 overlays of S$234m for "Middle East conflicts and Indonesia") suggest the cycle has been provisioned through rather than resolved (AGM 2026 responses; 3Q26 press release). OCBC discloses that its downside ECL sensitivity would add S$3,016m of expected credit losses (2024: S$2,173m) (AR2025). The collateral backdrop is mixed: JLL expects Central Hong Kong Grade A rents to rise 10–15% in 2026 but capital values to fall 0–5% with "tight credit conditions on commercial real estate loans", mainland existing-home prices fell 6.3% year on year in 1Q26, while Singapore private residential prices rose 1.4% in 3Q26 with housing NPLs at 0.5% (JLL, Jul 2026; JLL, Dec 2025; Global Property Guide; URA, 23 Oct 2026). Indonesia (NPL 2.5–2.6%) is the next watch item.

MARKET, RATE AND LIQUIDITY RISK: A S$1.95BN SUPERVISORY NII SHOCK, A BOND-HEAVY INSURER

Under the supervisory "Parallel Down" IRRBB scenario OCBC's one-year net interest income would fall by **S$1,951m** (2024: S$1,896m), higher because floating-rate exposure grew, while the "Parallel Up" scenario cuts economic value of equity by S$1,062m; the bank is therefore asset-sensitive to SGD rates and, with a lag, to USD rates, and management said in 2024 it had trimmed NII sensitivity to about S$4m per basis point using fixed-rate loans and cash-flow hedges (S$12.3bn of hedged assets at end-2025) (AR2025, Note 38; The Edge Singapore, Aug 2024). Trading risk is small (average aggregate VaR S$7.8m in 2025, five back-testing exceptions), funding is 80% customer deposits with CASA at 48.4%, USD loans-to-deposits of about 49% against 78.5% in SGD explain why rising US rates lift asset yields over time, and wholesale issuance spans a US$10bn covered-bond programme, AMTN, a US$1bn Tier 2 and the tokenised USCP programme (FY25 results presentation). Great Eastern adds the opposite sensitivity: a +100bp parallel shift cuts its after-tax profit by S$139m and a 20% equity fall by S$256m, which is exactly what produced the 48% quarter-on-quarter fall in insurance income in 3Q26 (AR2025, Note 38.4). For a forecasting vendor, the "what OCBC

needs to model" list is therefore SORA, SOFR and HIBOR scenario paths against the stated FY26 assumptions, Hong Kong and China CRE collateral-value paths, SME tariff pass-through and GEH's bond-portfolio marks.

CONDUCT RECORD: SCAM HANDLING, NOT AML, IS THE SCAR TISSUE

OCBC's regulatory history since 2021 is the S$330m scam-response capital add-on (whether MAS has lifted it is undisclosed), a S$600,000 AML composition penalty in June 2023 related to Wirecard-linked transactions, and, notably, absence from the July 2025 round in which MAS fined nine institutions S$27.45m over the 2023 S$3bn money-laundering case; MAS's enforcement summaries for the first three quarters of 2026 contain no OCBC action (The Edge Singapore, Jun 2023; Singapore Law Watch, Jul 2025; MAS Q3 2026 enforcement summary). Since 16 December 2024 the Shared Responsibility Framework puts the bank first in the loss waterfall for defined phishing scams if it breaches any of five duties (a 12-hour cooling-off after token activation or new-device login, real-time activity alerts, real-time outgoing-transaction alerts, a 24/7 reporting channel and self-service kill switch, and real-time fraud surveillance that holds a transaction for 24 hours when more than 50% of a balance drains within a day), with no liability cap (MAS Guidelines on Shared Responsibility Framework). National scam losses fell 19% to S$913.1m in 2025 (SPF Annual Scam and Cybercrime Brief 2025).

THE EXACT MAS RULES A THIRD-PARTY ANALYTICS OR AI VENDOR MUST SATISFY

A vendor to OCBC sits inside a layered regime, summarised below. The practical design consequences are: host in Singapore or at least under Singapore control (offshore processing of customer information triggers extra due diligence, foreign-supervisor-access policies and a 14-working-day MAS notification undertaking); accept a contract giving OCBC, MAS and MAS-appointed auditors audit and inspection rights, need-to-know access, no onward disclosure, breach notification, deletion on exit, prior notice of sub-contractors, notice before AI is introduced or changed, performance guarantees and exit portability; give OCBC "indirect control" over patching, MFA, encryption, API-key management, logging and penetration testing; supply enough model documentation, training-data provenance, evaluation results on OCBC's own data and prompt/output logs for OCBC to inventory, risk-rate and independently validate the use case; and accept that research or advice outputs reaching clients are a higher-materiality use case requiring human review before publication.

Rule (status, date)	What it requires of a vendor engagement
Banking Act s47 and Third Schedule; MAS FAQ on Notices 658/1121 (11 Dec 2024)	Customer information may go to a directly engaged service provider, but onward disclosure to a sub-contractor needs the customer's written consent and access by the provider's affiliates counts as disclosure by the bank (MAS FAQ)
MAS Notice 658, Management of Outsourced Relevant Services (binding from 11 Dec 2024)	Semi-annual register of outsourced services; documented evaluation of a material provider's ability, financial strength and (if overseas) local law, re-performed within 24 months; no sub-contracting of customer information without consent; contract must protect confidentiality, limit processing to what is necessary, allow MAS or its auditor "to audit the books, systems and premises of the service provider", give termination rights and require data to be "deleted, destroyed or rendered unusable" on exit; independent audit at least every three years; Annex C classes public cloud SaaS, PaaS and IaaS as outsourced services (MAS Notice 658)
MAS Guidelines on Outsourcing (Banks) (11 Dec 2024)	Due diligence resembling "a credit assessment of the viability of the service provider"; audit rights over provider and sub-contractors; no providers in jurisdictions where MAS access may be impeded; cloud data segregation with controls that "survive the tenure of the contract" (MAS Guidelines)
Proposed Guidelines on Third-Party Risk Management, P004-2026 (consulted 6 Mar–20 Apr 2026; not yet final)	Extends outsourcing expectations to all third-party services; single semi-annual register; rights over "data, software, models and IP" on exit; portability to avoid lock-in; Notice 658 remains the baseline (MAS consultation)
MAS Technology Risk Management Guidelines (18 Jan 2021)	Vendor evaluation "commensurate with the criticality"; review of the vendor's development and QA practices; source-code escrow assessment; third-party and open-source code review; API vetting, key expiry, encryption, logging; DLP and encryption of confidential data; penetration testing and adversarial simulation (MAS TRM Guidelines)
MAS Notice FSM-N05 Technology Risk Management (effective 10 May 2024)	Critical systems may not exceed 4 hours of unscheduled downtime in any 12 months; RTO of no more than 4 hours; MAS notified within 1 hour of a relevant incident; root-cause report within 14 days (FSM-N05)
MAS Notice FSM-N06 Cyber Hygiene (effective 10 May 2024)	Secured admin accounts, risk-based patching, written security standards per system, perimeter controls, malware protection, MFA for admin accounts on critical systems and for any internet access to customer information; the bank must be able to exercise "indirect control" by requiring the provider to comply (FSM-N06)
Circular on FI Incident Reporting (from 1 Feb 2026) and Guidelines on Business Continuity	Reportable incidents via MAS-Tx; critical business services with Service Recovery Time Objectives; third parties must be able to meet SRTOs via SLAs, BCP reviews, audits (ISO 22301 acceptable) or joint tests; concentration-risk management (MAS incident reporting circular; MAS BCM Guidelines)

Rule (status, date)	What it requires of a vendor engagement
Management (Jun 2022)	
Personal Data Protection Act (as amended 2020)	A vendor processing personal data is a data intermediary directly liable for protection and retention, must notify the bank of breaches without undue delay; PDPC notification within 3 days of assessing a notifiable breach; penalties up to 10% of Singapore turnover; NRIC numbers may not be used for authentication after 31 Dec 2026 (DLA Piper, Singapore)
FEAT Principles (2018), Veritas toolkit, Project MindForge handbook, AI Model Risk Management information paper (5 Dec 2024)	Fairness, ethics, accountability and transparency; for third-party AI the paper expects "compensatory testing", contingency planning and contract clauses on "performance guarantees, data protection, the right to audit, and notification when AI is introduced"; GenAI kept to augmenting humans with a human in the loop (MAS AI MRM paper; MAS FEAT)
Guidelines on Artificial Intelligence Risk Management (consulted 13 Nov 2025–31 Jan 2026; final issued 7 Oct 2026)	Applies to all FIs and to "third-party AI … incorporated within, or used in the delivery of, services to the FI"; governance, inventory and Impact/Complexity/Reliance materiality assessments within 12 months (about Oct 2027), full lifecycle controls within 24 months (about Oct 2028), high-risk use cases "as soon as possible"; third-party AI must be tested "in the context of the FI's use cases (including using the FI's own data)"; self-attestations "would generally not be considered as effective" and ISO 42001 or SOC 2 "are not the only means"; contracts must give visibility of model changes; human review of all decisions is the example for higher-materiality uses, which include "the provision of financial advisory or fund management services"; enhanced documentation "such as logging prompts and their outputs" for GenAI (MAS Response to Feedback, 7 Oct 2026; MAS consultation paper)
Financial Advisers Act; FAA-G13 (8 Oct 2018); FAA-N16 (amended 29 Dec 2025); CMG-G02 (2019)	"Issuing or promulgating research analyses or reports" is a regulated financial advisory service (exempt only for up to 30 accredited investors per occasion); research under OCBC's name is OCBC's regulated activity, so FAA-G13 conflict-of-interest controls, FAA-N16 suitability rules where recommendations are made and the digital-advisory guidelines on algorithm governance bind the content workflow (MAS FAQs on Exempt Persons; FAA-G13; FAA-N16; CMG-G02)

The AIRG deadlines create a near-term buying window: every bank must build an AI inventory with materiality ratings and evaluation evidence by roughly October 2027, and a vendor whose product generates that evidence as a by-product is selling compliance as well as analytics.

MACRO BACKDROP: AN AI-LED UPCYCLE THAT MAS EXPECTS TO COOL THROUGH 2027

Singapore's economy grew 5.4% year on year in 3Q26 after 5.9% in 2Q and 6.3% in 1Q, MTI raised its 2026 forecast to 4.5–5.5% in August, and MAS held its S$NEER appreciation path on 14 October 2026 with core inflation seen at 1.5–2.0% in 2026 and 1.5–2.5% in 2027, warning that "global financial conditions are expected to tighten, and the AI-driven growth cycle is expected to ease" with AI-related activity "moderating in the latter half of 2027"; professional forecasters put 2027 growth at 3.1% (MAS Monetary Policy

Statement, 14 Oct 2026; MTI, 11 Aug 2026). The Fed held at 3.75–4.00% on 28 October 2026 with two dissents favouring a hike, so OCBC's "one more hike" assumption is consistent with the FOMC's own split (Federal Reserve, 28 Oct 2026). Tariff risk has narrowed: the Supreme Court struck down the IEEPA tariffs on 20 February 2026, a 10% Section 122 surcharge replaced them for Singapore and others, and Section 232 duties target semiconductors (WilmerHale, 20 Feb 2026). MAS's FSR flags stretched AI equity valuations, private-credit losses, hyperscalers' "novel and potentially circular private financing arrangements" and CRE as the system's key risks (MAS FSR 2025). The 2025–2026 story was "NIM down, volumes and fees up"; the 2027 setup is the reverse, with a Fed on hold-to-hiking, SORA stabilised near 1.1–1.2% and a 14%-larger loan base supporting NII while fee income becomes more cyclical if AI-led exuberance cools. In order of likely P&L impact, the risks to model are a Middle East energy shock, an AI-capex pullback hitting TMT and digital-infrastructure lending and wealth flows, Indonesia, and Hong Kong and China CRE values.

DBS leads on AI scale and research; OCBC leads on 2026 earnings and asset quality

DBS is the scale, return and AI benchmark. Its 9M26 profit was a record S$8.82bn at 17.0% ROE on wealth AUM of S$544bn, it became the first Singapore company to pass S$200bn of market value in July 2026, and MAS cut its operational-risk capital multiplier on 4 November 2026 citing improved technology and operational-risk controls, though 3Q26 profit fell 5% and missed consensus as markets trading income collapsed 65% (DBS 3Q26 release; Dr Wealth, 6 Nov 2026). Its AI disclosure is the template a vendor will be judged against: **approximately S$1bn of economic value from AI and analytics in 2025** (S$750m in 2024) from more than 2,000 models across 430+ use cases, DBS-GPT available to over 90% of staff producing about 1.8 million prompts a month, 10,000 personal agents created within months of launch, a corporate credit-memo system of up to 70 agents given to about 1,500 RMs and credit managers in August 2026, and the Joy and digibot assistants serving more than 10 million customers (The Edge via Yahoo, 8 Mar 2026; VnExpress, 4 Oct 2026). CEO Tan Su Shan, in post since March 2025, frames the move "from AI as a copilot to AI operating on autopilot" with all 40,000 staff receiving foundational AI training, leadership offsite T-shirts reading "Talk is cheap. Show me your agent", and about S$25bn of AI-related financing arranged in 2026 (VnExpress). DBS swept Global Finance's 2026 World's Best Digital Bank (the first Asia-headquartered winner in 27 years), World's Best Bank for AI in Finance and fraud-AI awards, Euromoney's Singapore's best bank and world's and Asia's best private bank, and ranks 19th in Brand Finance's Banking 500 at US$18.6bn against OCBC's 65th at US$6.8bn (Fintech News Singapore, 30 Oct 2026; Euromoney PB 2026; Brand Finance, 5 Mar 2026). DBS also disclosed about S$14.6bn of data-centre exposure, a concentration OCBC has not quantified (Dr Wealth).

UOB is the ASEAN retail-scale competitor and the one buying rather than building AI. The Citi consumer integration gave it more than 8.5 million customers, 82% digitally enabled, top consumer card billings in ASEAN and Euromoney's ASEAN best retail bank 2026; wealth AUM is S$204bn with a target to double wealth income by 2030 (UOB Annual Report 2025; The Asian Banker, 8 May 2026). Wee Ee Cheong calls the approach "augmented intelligence": 300+ AI and analytics use cases, Microsoft Copilot for more than 35,000 staff, a three-year Accenture AI Refinery deal, Cloudera's DAITA iQ, an FPT MoU and the AURA agentic programme (Fintech News Singapore, 14 Oct 2026; UOB–FPT, 2 Jun 2026). Its 3Q26 profit of S$1.25bn missed the S$1.38bn consensus, NIM of 1.68% is the lowest of the three, Greater China NPLs are

5.0%, and it is selling UOB Asset Management to Allianz Global Investors (Beansprout UOB 3Q26). Its research team is the most transparently staffed of the three, with a named 15-person roster and a quarterly house-view PDF (UOB research team).

GLOBAL BANKS ARE IMPORTING ENTERPRISE AI INTO SINGAPORE WEALTH

In Asia private banking by AUM, UBS (US$795bn), HSBC (US$302bn) and J.P. Morgan (US$299bn) dwarf Bank of Singapore's US$145bn-plus, so OCBC competes on ASEAN, Greater China and Global South Asia niches rather than scale (finews.asia, 31 Mar 2026). The clearest live analogues to an AI research platform are HSBC's "Wealth Intelligence", an in-house generative platform on OpenAI models that summarises more than 10,000 sources and prioritises HSBC CIO reports for private-bank staff in Hong Kong and Singapore, and its "AI Prepare" client-pack generator; HSBC is hiring more than 100 AI specialists and about 100 relationship managers in Singapore, siting its Global AI Centre of Excellence there from 2H26, and its June 2026 Google Cloud partnership targets 200+ Gemini-based use cases with RM decision assistants (FinTech Global, 18 Sep 2025; Global Banking & Finance/Reuters, 27 Jul 2026; HSBC, 17 Jun 2026). Standard Chartered runs SC GPT for about 80,000 staff and its AI programme is eliminating roughly 8,000 roles; Deutsche Bank and RBC are hiring Singapore private bankers, including from Bank of Singapore, while Bank of Singapore in turn hired Julius Baer's Southeast Asia head (NextGenProdMan, 16 May 2026; Euromoney PB 2026). Regionally, Maybank committed MYR10bn over five years to technology, data and AI on top of a RM1bn Microsoft deal with Copilot for 44,000 staff, CIMB runs practical GenAI (EVA chatbot, WhatsApp advisory), BCA became the first Southeast Asian bank with ISO/IEC 42001 AI certification and the world's strongest banking brand, Bank Mandiri won TAB Global's 2026 AI personalisation award, and the HKMA says about 80% of Hong Kong banks already use AI (Tech Wire Asia, Dec 2025; Marketing-Interactive). OCBC's Malaysian and Indonesian subsidiaries therefore face local leaders with AI budgets of the same order as the group's.

DIGITAL CHALLENGERS ERODE THE ENTRY TIER; NO ONE HAS ANNOUNCED A RESEARCH-AUTOMATION VENDOR

Singapore's digital banks and apps are now measurable: Trust Bank has more than 1 million customers and its first profitable month in March 2026, GXS is Euromoney's Singapore best digital bank 2026 with more than 3 million regional customers, Green Link Digital Bank posted the first full-year digital-bank profit (S$16.1m, roughly 570 times smaller than OCBC's pre-tax profit), moomoo claims more than 1.5 million Singapore users and about 40% of investment-app downloads, Tiger is SIAS's best retail broker 2026, and Syfe passed S$20bn of AUM with 400,000 users, "Curate with AI" and a J.P. Morgan-powered portfolio (Fintech News Singapore digital banking report 2026; moomoo SG; Fintech News Singapore, 22 Sep 2026). Combined digital-bank deposits are under 2% of OCBC's S$461bn, so the threat is to young-segment CASA, card spend and retail brokerage (where DBS Vickers' S$10.90 minimum undercuts OCBC Securities' S$25), not funding; robo and trading apps are shipping AI research features faster than incumbents' retail apps, and OCBC's answer, the WoW avatars, is gated to clients with S$1.5m (MoneySmart brokerage guide 2026). No official per-bank Singapore market-share series exists; on group balances OCBC and UOB are level on loans (S$372bn each) behind DBS (S$479bn), OCBC's 14% loan growth against UOB's 6% implies it is taking share, OCBC ranks second on wealth AUM and first on wealth income as a share of total income (38%), UOB leads cards, and Great Eastern's Singapore bancassurance channel is shrinking even as its agency channel booms (OCBC 3Q26 release; Insurance Business Asia, 1 Aug 2026). No public vendor

selection for research automation or forecasting exists at DBS, OCBC or UOB; the visible vendor pattern is Microsoft, Cloudera and Red Hat as infrastructure, Accenture and FPT at UOB, an AlphaSense client logo at DBS, and MAS's Project MindForge (24 institutions with AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft and Nvidia) as the shared governance forum, alongside S$220m of FSTI 4.0 funding and a July 2026 agentic-finance framework (AlphaSense; Fintech News Singapore, 14 Oct 2026).

WHERE OCBC LEADS AND LAGS, AS ANALYSTS AND THE PRESS SCORE IT

OCBC leads on 2026 earnings momentum (the only bank to beat 3Q26 consensus; record 9M26 profit; a one-year share return of 56% against DBS's 27% and UOB's 9%), on asset quality (NPL 0.8%, coverage 168%), on wealth-fee growth (FY2025 wealth fees +33%, fastest of the three) and on diversification through an insurance earnings stream "DBS and UOB lack"; The Singaporean Investor called it the 2Q26 "clear standout" with DBS "a distant second" and Macquarie's Jayden Vantarakis credited it with the strongest revenue momentum (Beansprout, 14 Apr 2026; The Singaporean Investor, 11 Aug 2026). On AI execution, a May 2026 secondary analysis rated OCBC "The Deployer" with five agentic models in production, "the most advanced in Singapore" on agentic autonomy, against DBS "The Builder" and UOB "The Partner" (NextGenProdMan, 16 May 2026). It lags on ROE (13.5% versus 17.0%), NIM (lowest group NIM of the three at 1.66%), wealth scale (S$358bn versus S$544bn), dividend yield (3.6%, now the lowest), cost efficiency (DBS's structural cost advantage is attributed to "multi-year investments in technology and AI"), quantified AI disclosure (no economic-value figure, an older 300+ use-case count, an avatar beta for 50 users against assistants serving 10 million), brand rank (fell from 61st to 65th), ESG transparency (UOB publishes MSCI AA, Sustainalytics 14.8 and CDP A-; OCBC publishes no scores and faced a 2026 SGX complaint over sustainability disclosures), research visibility (no named roster, stale portal) and strategy specificity (no ROE target); Dr Wealth's shorthand is DBS the "tech-forward alpha" and OCBC the "conservative, steady-yielding middle child" (Fintech News Singapore, 14 Oct 2026; UOB ESG ratings; KnowESG OCBC; Dr Wealth, 12 May 2026). The measurable gaps are disclosure and scale, not absence of capability; because OCBC's 2026 outperformance makes "lagging" claims politically sensitive inside the bank, a pitch should frame the gaps as structural (ROE, NIM, wealth scale, measured AI value, research infrastructure) rather than cyclical.

Twenty-two months of dated developments, January 2025 to November 2026

The period spans Helen Wong's final year (record FY2024 profit, the S$2.5bn capital return, the failed Great Eastern delisting, a leadership refresh) and Tan Teck Long's first ten months (Next Frontier, the HSBC Indonesia deal, the technology budget, record profits, top global rankings, raised guidance). No MAS enforcement action against OCBC was found for 2025–2026 (MAS Q1 2026; MAS Q2 2026).

Date	Development
6 Jan 2025	First Singapore bank to sell bespoke tokenised bonds via its asset-tokenisation platform (OCBC)
26 Feb 2025	FY2024 record net profit S$7.59bn; S$2.5bn two-year capital return; 14% CET1 target; 60% payout (OCBC)
29 Mar 2025	OCBC SeniorCare launched (more than 180,000 seniors reached by February 2026) (Group CEO's Perspectives)
14 May 2025	OCBC Securities, OSBHK and OCBC Sekuritas to be integrated into Global Markets from 1 July (OCBC)
27 May 2025	Wholesale leadership refresh: Linus Goh retires; Elaine Heng to head Global Commercial Banking from 1 October (OCBC)
6 Jun 2025	OCBC backs Great Eastern delisting with a S$0.9bn exit offer at S$30.15 (OCBC)
8 Jul 2025	GEH EGM: delisting fails at 63.49%; bonus issue and Class C shares approved (OCBC)
11 Jul 2025	Tan Teck Long named Group CEO from 1 January 2026; Helen Wong to retire (OCBC)
17 Jul 2025	Quantum research collaborations with NUS, NTU and SMU (OCBC)
21 Aug 2025	Great Eastern shares resume trading; OCBC voting stake 88.2% (Dr Wealth)
25 Aug 2025	US$1bn digital US commercial-paper programme on blockchain (OCBC)
Sep 2025	S$3bn One Group incremental-revenue target surpassed ahead of time (AR2025)
24 Sep 2025	Carina Lee appointed Group CRO from 1 January 2026 (OCBC)
5 Nov 2025	Melvyn Low appointed Group Chief Strategy and Transformation Officer (OCBC)
20–24 Nov 2025	Eight Southeast Asian wallets added to the app; in-app calls for retail and business customers (OCBC)
18 Dec 2025	Late-morning digital-banking login disruption, about 1,000 Downdetector reports (TS2)
31 Dec 2025	Helen Wong retires as Group CEO; Noel D'Cruz retires as Group CRO (AR2025)

Date	Development
1 Jan 2026	Tan Teck Long becomes Group CEO; Carina Lee Group CRO
4 Feb 2026	Tops SGD bond bookrunner league table for a second year (OCBC)
25 Feb 2026	FY2025 results (net profit S$7.42bn, –2%); “The Next Frontier” strategy launched; GE “a chapter behind us” (OCBC)
3 Mar 2026	Great Eastern Private launched for HNW clients (Great Eastern)
7 Apr 2026	Target to support 12,000 SMEs with sustainable financing by 2028 (OCBC)
14 Apr 2026	Andrew Khoo becomes Great Eastern chairman (secondary source) (MarketScreener)
15 Apr 2026	Generative-AI skills training for all wealth advisers; appointments doubled, revenue +50% (OCBC)
16 Apr 2026	89th AGM: all resolutions passed; Tan Yen Yen retires (AGM results)
20 Apr 2026	GOLDX, Southeast Asia’s first on-chain tokenised physical gold fund, with Lion Global and DigiFT (OCBC)
4 May 2026	OCBC Indonesia agrees to buy HSBC Indonesia’s wealth and premier banking business (336,000 customers; completion 2Q27) (OCBC)
8 May 2026	1Q26 net profit S$1.97bn (+5%); CFO says the remaining ~S$800m of capital return could be a special dividend (OCBC)
15 May 2026	Plan to add 30–50 relationship managers in Hong Kong in 2026 (Reuters via Yahoo)
10 Jun 2026	Bank of Singapore reorganises into ASEAN, Greater China and Middle East/Global South Asia market groups (Bank of Singapore)
1 Jul 2026	OCBC WoW avatar banking app unveiled; more than S$1bn a year on technology; 600 RMs pledged (OCBC)
29 Jul 2026	HELIOS agentic due-diligence platform at Bank of Singapore (OCBC)
31 Jul 2026	Great Eastern 1H26 profit +43%; interim dividend 35 cents (Great Eastern)
7 Aug 2026	1H26 record net profit S$4.19bn (+13%); 2Q26 record S$2.22bn; interim dividend 47 cents; loan guidance raised (OCBC)

Date	Development
10 Sep 2026	DBS, OCBC and UOB complete first live blockchain SGD transactions on Swift's ledger (OCBC)
17 Sep 2026	Ten-year strategic cooperation agreement renewed with Bank of Ningbo (OCBC)
7 Oct 2026	MAS issues final Guidelines on AI Risk Management; tokenised-deposit treasury solution with Ant International (MAS; OCBC)
8–14 Oct 2026	Citi downgrades to Sell (S$27.50); Macquarie to Hold (S$30.00) (Investing.com)
22 Oct 2026	"One-Person Company" AI hackathon for 33,000 employees (OCBC)
23 Oct 2026	Afternoon mobile and internet banking disruption; "intermittent slowness", no data compromised (The Star)
27 Oct 2026	Ranked strongest bank in Singapore and Asia Pacific and third globally by The Asian Banker; first in Forbes/Statista's World's Top Performing Banks; shares +46.8% YTD (OCBC)
6 Nov 2026	3Q26 net profit S$2.04bn (beat); 9M26 record S$6.24bn; guidance raised; close S$27.73 (OCBC)
Ahead	16 Nov 2026 Angus Tsang becomes OCBC HK Head of Wholesale Banking; late Nov MAS FSR 2026 and MTI 2027 forecast; 1Q27 OCBC Punggol opens; late Feb 2027 FY2026 results and final capital-return special; 2Q27 HSBC Indonesia completion; ~Oct 2027 AIRG governance deadline

Where an AI forecasting and research-publishing platform fits, who sponsors it, and how to pitch it

WHAT THE USER ALREADY HAS, STATED HONESTLY

BharatFinQA ("Benchmarking Cross-Sectoral Financial Reasoning in the Indian Corporate Ecosystem") is an evidence-grounded financial-QA benchmark built from FY2025 annual reports of 187 NSE/BSE companies: 5,618 human-verified items (5,050 standard plus 568 adversarial unanswerable probes) across seven task families from extraction to multi-hop synthesis and sentiment–financial divergence, produced by an OCR-to-Markdown, section-aware chunking, relevance-scoring and persona-prompted generation pipeline that enforces "a 100% verbatim evidence copy-paste rule", and scored by a tier-aware protocol (BFQ-Score) with a pinned LLM judge (BharatFinQA paper source; pipeline README). Its headline result is that a US-benchmark-specialised model gains +31.7 points on the benchmark family it was trained on and "nothing measurable on Indian filings" (difference-in-differences +29.2, 95% CI +19.1 to +39.7), that the best generalist scores about 80–82% judged correctness, that judge-instruction changes move scores by 10.9 points against 3.5 for judge-model changes, and that human agreement is κ 0.711 on annotation and 0.742 on judge validation (rebuttal README). It was resubmitted to ACL ARR October 2026 as submission #4503

after a “3 = Findings” meta-review in the August cycle; it is under review, not accepted, and reviewers’ open concerns (no expert-authored queries, no retrieval track, 41% majority-flag label noise on the Hard tier) should be disclosed rather than hidden (session transcript).

FinSafeQA-XL is the more OCBC-relevant asset. The draft (“FinSafeQA: A Point-in-Time, Evidence-Grounded Benchmark for Safe-Asset Financial QA”, targeted at ACL 2027 via the 4 January 2027 ARR deadline) describes **118,912 QA pairs across 13 markets and 114 instruments, “every item stamped with a source URL, document hash, and as-of date”**, a 3,160-item stratified evaluation split, a three-condition protocol (closed-book, BM25 retrieval, oracle evidence) and a 12-model sweep in which “closed-book accuracy never exceeds .211 … while oracle accuracy caps at .728: the binding constraint is using context, not having it” (FinSafeQA ACL draft; RESEARCH.md). The pool is dominated by machine-verified records from official APIs, including about 76,000 Singapore items built from MAS SGS bond, T-bill and SSB data, CPF rate histories (126 quarterly and 7,060 daily records with URL, SHA-256 and fetch-date provenance) and SDIC deposit-insurance rules, and the harvest exposed a real data-quality trap: legacy SORA answers keyed to publication date rather than value date (RESEARCH.md). The intervention study yields bank-grade engineering findings: supervised fine-tuning “buys accuracy but destroys abstention (not-found recall .92→.51)”, holdout-DPO “repairs abstention almost for free”, correctness-conditioned confidence labels add 23 points of abstention at 1.5B parameters while cutting calibration error 57%, a calculator tool lifts a small model’s financial-calculation accuracy from .094 to .306, and “no tuned variant beats its base under RAG or oracle” (FinSafeQA README; E24 tables). Human-versus-judge agreement is still “TBD” with annotation due mid-November, the licence is “research preview — do not redistribute” pending review, and retrieval is BM25-only, so the honest framing is “in preparation for ACL 2027 with dataset, code and protocol built” (project memory). Two side studies transfer directly: a reproducible event study of nine NSE sector indices around 61 RBI policy announcements (market-model abnormal returns, Holm correction, bootstrap, panel fixed effects, 19 unit tests) and 322 instrument-years of safe-asset rate history with nine stress events (RBI event study README).

morluto/rea is “REA: Reverse Engineer Anything”, an MIT-licensed TypeScript CLI and MCP server (version 6.8.0, created April 2026, very active with eight-plus contributors in the first week of November) for reverse-engineering binaries, Electron apps, .NET, APKs, firmware and websites; a case-insensitive search of the clone finds “ocbc” only inside a package-lock integrity hash and “singapore” nowhere, so it reveals nothing about OCBC and should not be cited as a source about the bank (rea README; GitHub). Its transferable ideas are architectural: an evidence contract that separates “observations, derivations, inferences, and unknowns” with provenance on every result, a layered domain-to-adapter architecture, MCP packaging so any agent can call analytics tools, and a “record a session, turn its API into tools, export an environment” pattern for testing agents over recorded internal traffic without production access (rea AGENTS.md). The 437,368-star count returned by the GitHub API is implausible for a seven-month-old project and should not be quoted. Two hygiene items precede any outreach: API keys and server credentials pasted into the BharatFinQA session should be rotated, and the user should confirm whether a different “rea” repository was intended.

THE FIT: SIX ENTRY POINTS MAPPED TO OCBC'S DIVISIONS

OCBC's AI investment is concentrated in distribution (avatars, RM summarisation, adviser training) and operations (onboarding, KYC, credit documents); nothing in its announcements covers the forecasting, valuation or research-production layer, and Group Research's own 2025 mandate is to build "a comprehensive multi-asset research platform" while expanding single-name coverage (AR2025, p.45). The platform should therefore be positioned as the research and forecasting factory beneath OCBC's existing channels, not as a new channel.

Entry point	Division and sponsor	What the user's assets contribute
Forecasting engine and research-publishing pipeline (macro, FX, rates, credit, equities) with a public forecast-accuracy ledger	Global Markets (Kenneth Lai) and OCBC Group Research (Selena Ling, Frances Cheung, Carmen Lee)	The "data harvest with provenance → experiments → results-of-record → figure scripts → publishable artefact → datasheet" loop from both papers; point-in-time corpus so every note is reproducible "as of" its date; scores the 2026 revision history (Fed, Singapore GDP, gold) as the first demonstration
AI-equity valuation and scenario showcase (capex payback, hyperscaler debt, correction probabilities)	Bank of Singapore CIO office (Jean Chia, Eli Lee, Low Pei Han) and Wealth Advisory (Chez Anbu)	Fills the stated vacuum: every unit discusses AI capex qualitatively and none publishes a model; additive to the "bull market intact" house view, not contradictory
Grounded, point-in-time product and market knowledge for client-facing assistants (OCBC WoW, Wealth Insights, A.I. Oscar)	Global Consumer Financial Services (Sunny Quek) with the Group Data Office	FinSafeQA-XL's Singapore SGS, T-bill, SSB, CPF and SDIC corpus with hashes and as-of dates; the three-condition protocol and calibration map as the pre-deployment gate; the "advice-boundary compliance" idea for MAS FAA constraints
"Ask the filing" over SGX annual reports and SGXNet, plus forensic red-flag screens (OCF versus profit divergence, related-party transactions, cross-table contradictions, governance risk) feeding the RM Credit Copilot	Global Corporate and Commercial Banking (Elaine Lam, Elaine Heng) and Group Credit Risk (Carina Lee)	BharatFinQA's corpus-agnostic pipeline and forensic-auditor question families, with verbatim evidence and judge-validated confidence on every answer; an internal benchmark of which models read Singapore filings reliably
Model-risk and AI-governance evidence pack (inventory attributes, materiality, evaluation on OCBC data, prompt and output logs)	Group CRO (Carina Lee), Group Data Office (Donald MacDonald), Group Legal and Compliance (Loretta Yuen)	Pinned judges with prompt hashes, κ and AC1 reporting, flag-rate re-weighting, the "every number recomputed from raw predictions" verifier; maps one-to-one onto the AIRG's inventory, materiality and documentation expectations
Scenario forecasting of NII, funding cost and GEH marks under SORA, SOFR and HIBOR paths	Group CFO (Goh Chin Yee) and Global Markets ALM	The RBI event-study framework ported to MAS statements and SORA/S$NEER moves; the rate-transmission map (policy rate → SORA → deposit and loan rates → SGS curve → CPF and SSB administered rates) rebuilt for Singapore; disclosed IRRBB figures (Parallel Down –S$1,951m) as calibration anchors

Regional roll-out runs through Wang Ke (Hong Kong, where OCBC wants to "scale up Global Markets"), Parwati Surjaudaja (Indonesia, which already publishes a monthly Market Outlook quoting the group's analysts) and Tan Chor Sen (Malaysia, where avatars and agentic AI are due in 2027); enterprise

sponsorship sits with Melvyn Low's Strategy and Transformation Office and Praveen Raina's Operations and Technology (OCBC Indonesia Market Outlook; The Star, 10 Aug 2026).

HOW TO PITCH IT SO LEADERSHIP ONBOARDS OR INVESTS

First, speak OCBC's language and accept its premise that "AI is just a tool": present the platform as fit-for-purpose ADD, data first, deterministic guardrails second, models third, with a human in the loop before anything reaches a client, which mirrors both the WoW architecture and the AIRG's expectation of human review for financial-advisory use cases (OCBC release, 1 Jul 2026). Second, lead with measurement, because that is the gap every critic names and the CEO concedes: DBS reports about S$1bn of AI value and OCBC's 2027 target of "2x revenue contributed by AI" has no baseline, so the platform's first deliverable should be a forecast-accuracy and AI-value ledger that scores OCBC's own published calls (the 2026 Fed, GDP and gold revisions are the ready-made test set) and attributes revenue and cost outcomes to specific AI use cases (AR2024; The Asian Banker, 27 Oct 2026). Third, demonstrate on what OCBC already talks about: an AI-equity valuation scenario dashboard that quantifies capex payback and hyperscaler debt paths behind Chez Anbu's "claim on future profits" argument, and a Singapore rates dashboard that tracks SORA, SOFR and HIBOR against management's FY26 assumptions, both published through a modern portal that fixes the stale research hub. Fourth, meet the infrastructure and cost constraints head on: deploy on OCBC's on-premise GPUs, Cloudera and OpenShift estate with open-weight models and frontier escalation, citing FinSafeQA's own evidence that open 7–8B models reach .65 oracle accuracy against .73 for the frontier, and that grounding in dated official documents beats fine-tuning, which keeps the cost line and the "very cost conscious" CEO on side (E24 tables). Fifth, arrive compliance-ready: a Notice 658-compliant contract (audit rights for OCBC and MAS, need-to-know access, no onward disclosure, deletion on exit, sub-contractor and AI-change notification, exit portability), Singapore hosting, FSM-N05/N06 controls, PDPA data-intermediary terms, FAA-G13 conflict controls on any published research, and an AIRG evidence pack that lets Carina Lee's team inventory, rate and validate the use case before the October 2027 deadline. Sixth, size it for OCBC's buying behaviour: the bank has no venture arm, buys through partnerships with regulated counterparties and prefers builds its engineers can extend, so propose a time-boxed pilot owned by the Group Data Office with one business sponsor (Global Markets or Bank of Singapore), procured under the CFO, with success defined in the same revenue and productivity terms OCBC already uses for its adviser-training programme (OCBC release, 15 Apr 2026). Seventh, time it: the next catalysts are MAS's FSR and MTI's 2027 forecast in late November 2026, FY2026 results in late February 2027 when the capital-return special is paid and 2027 guidance set, the Punggol hub opening in 1Q27, and the AIRG governance deadline in October 2027.

The objections are predictable. "We build in-house" is answered by shipping the pipeline, judges and verifier as components the Group Data Office can own, not a black box. "Costs are under scrutiny" is answered by on-premise deployment and a value ledger that reports its own payback. "Outages are a board topic" is answered by classifying the pilot outside OCBC's critical systems and keeping client channels for phase two. "The family is conservative" is answered by a pilot-sized commitment tied to measurable wealth-fee and research-productivity outcomes rather than a platform bet. And the credibility risk of overclaiming is answered by describing the papers exactly as they are: a benchmark under ACL review with a Findings-level prior meta-review, and an ACL 2027 draft whose Singapore corpus, protocol and training findings already exist.

Conclusion

The research changes the shape of the opportunity. OCBC is not an AI laggard that needs capability; it is a bank with production agents, six million daily AI decisions and a billion-dollar technology budget that has chosen not to measure, model or publish, and whose research function has been consolidated under Global Markets with an explicit but unresourced mandate to become a multi-asset platform. The gap between what OCBC does and what it can show is widest exactly where a forecasting, research-publishing and dashboard platform operates: forecast tracking, valuation and scenario models, AI-value attribution and modern distribution of house views. MAS's October 2026 AI guidelines convert that gap into a dated obligation, since every AI use case must be inventoried, risk-rated and validated on the bank's own data by October 2027, and a vendor whose product generates that evidence as a by-product sells compliance and analytics at once.

The second shift is in how the user's own work should be presented. The Indian benchmark is not the asset; the discipline is, and FinSafeQA-XL's hash-stamped, as-of-dated Singapore safe-asset corpus plus its findings that grounding beats fine-tuning and that abstention must be diagnosed before it is trained are the exact arguments a conservative, scam-scarred, cost-conscious bank needs to hear before it lets an assistant speak to a Premier client. Pitched as a fit-for-purpose ADD component that Global Markets and the Group Data Office can own, that runs on-premise, that scores itself, and that arrives with its MAS paperwork written, the proposal lands on the one thing OCBC's 2026 outperformance has not bought it: proof.